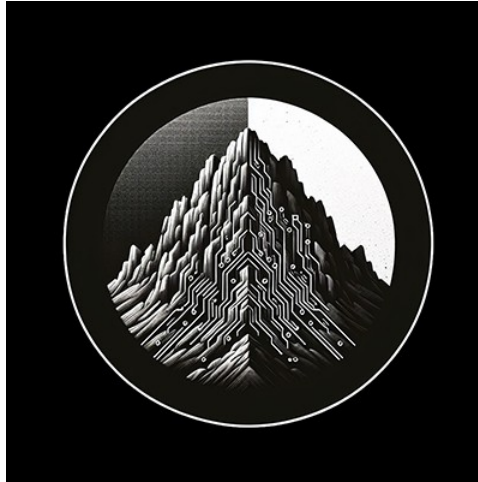




RTL Design Sherpa

APB Crossbar Micro-Architecture Specification 1.0

January 3, 2026

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Apbx Xbar Mas Index

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APB Crossbar Micro-Architecture Specification Index

Component: APB Crossbar (MxN Interconnect) **Version:** 1.0 **Date:** 2026-01-03 **Purpose:** Detailed micro-architecture specification for APB Crossbar component

Document Organization

This specification covers the APB Crossbar component - a parametric MxN interconnect for connecting multiple APB masters to multiple APB slaves with automatic address-based routing and round-robin arbitration.

Main Documentation

[README.md](#)

Chapter 1: Architecture

[chapters/01_architecture.md](#)

Chapter 2: Address Decode and Arbitration

[chapters/02_address_and_arbitration.md](#)

Chapter 3: RTL Generator

[chapters/03_rtl_generator.md](#)

Quick Navigation

For New Users

1. Start with [README.md](#) for overview and quick start
2. Read [01_architecture.md](#) to understand the design
3. Study [02_address_and_arbitration.md](#) for operational details
4. Reference [03_rtl_generator.md](#) if custom configuration needed

For Integration

- **Pre-generated variants:** See [01_architecture.md](#) Section “Pre-Generated Variants”
- **Custom generation:** See [03_rtl_generator.md](#) Section “Quick Start”
- **Address mapping:** See [02_address_and_arbitration.md](#) Section “Address Decode”
- **Arbitration behavior:** See [02_address_and_arbitration.md](#) Section “Arbitration”

Common Questions

All answered in [README.md](#) Section “Common Questions”

Visual Assets

All diagrams referenced in the documentation are available in:

- **Source Files:**
 - `assets/graphviz/*.gv` - Graphviz source diagrams
 - `assets/wavedrom/*.json` - WaveJSON timing diagrams
- **Rendered Files:**
 - `assets/png/*.png` - PNG format (for document generation)

Architecture Diagrams

1. **APB Crossbar Architecture (2x4 Example)**
 - Source: [assets/graphviz/apbx_xbar_architecture.gv](#)
 - Rendered: [assets/png/apbx_xbar_architecture.png](#)
2. **Address Decode Flow**
 - Source: [assets/graphviz/address_decode_flow.gv](#)

- Rendered: [assets/png/address_decode_flow.png](#)

Timing Diagrams

1. Round-Robin Arbitration

- Source: [assets/wavedrom/arbitration_round_robin.json](#)
 - Rendered: [assets/wavedrom/arbitration_round_robin.png](#)
-

Component Overview

Key Features

- **Parametric MxN Configuration:** Any combination of M masters and N slaves (up to 16x16)
- **Automatic Address Decode:** 64KB per slave, simple offset-based routing
- **Round-Robin Arbitration:** Per-slave fair arbitration, no master starvation
- **Zero-Bubble Throughput:** Back-to-back transactions without idle cycles
- **Grant Persistence:** Hold grant through transaction completion
- **RTL Generation:** Python-based generator for custom configurations

Pre-Generated Variants

Module	M×N	Use Case
apbx_xbar_1to1	1×1	Passthrough, protocol conversion
apbx_xbar_2to1	2×1	Multi-master arbitration
apbx_xbar_1to4	1×4	Simple SoC peripheral bus
apbx_xbar_2to4	2×4	Typical SoC with CPU+DMA
apbx_xbar_thin	1×1	Minimal overhead passthrough

Design Philosophy

Proven Building Blocks: - Built from production-tested apb4_slave and apb4_master modules -
No new protocol logic - pure composition - Each component independently verified

Parametric Generation: - Generator creates any MxN configuration - Pre-generated common variants for fast integration - Custom variants generated on-demand

Clean Separation: - Master-side: APB slaves convert protocol → cmd/rsp - Internal: Arbitration + address decoding - Slave-side: APB masters convert cmd/rsp → protocol

Related Documentation

Companion Specifications

- [APB Crossbar HAS](#) - Hardware Architecture Specification (high-level)

Project-Level

- **PRD.md:** [../PRD.md](#) - Complete product requirements document
- **CLAUDE.md:** [../CLAUDE.md](#) - AI assistant integration guide
- **README.md:** [../README.md](#) - Quick start guide

Test Infrastructure

- **Test Directory:** `../dv/tests/` - CocoTB + pytest test suite
- **Test Results:** All pre-generated variants 100% passing

RTL

- **Core Modules:** `../rtl/apbx_xbar_*.sv` - Pre-generated crossbars
 - **Wrappers:** `../rtl/wrappers/` - Pre-configured wrappers
 - **Generator:** `../bin/generate_xbars.py` - Python generator script
-

Version History

Version 1.0 (2025-10-25): - Initial specification release - Complete visual documentation (3 diagrams) - Comprehensive generator documentation - All pre-generated variants verified (100% passing)

Last Updated: 2026-01-03 **Maintained By:** RTL Design Sherpa Project

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APB Crossbar Visual Documentation

Component: APB Crossbar (MxN Interconnect) **Version:** 1.0 **Status:** Production Ready **Last Updated:** 2025-10-25

Overview

This directory contains visual documentation for the APB Crossbar component, including architecture diagrams, timing waveforms, and generator documentation.

Component Purpose: Parametric MxN APB interconnect connecting multiple masters to multiple slaves with automatic address-based routing and round-robin arbitration.

Documentation Structure

Main Documentation Files

Document	Description	Contents
01_architecture.md	Architecture Overview	Top-level block diagram, functional blocks, signal flow, parameters
02_address_and_arbitration.md	Address Decode & Arbitration	Address map structure, decode algorithm, round-robin timing
03_rtl_generator.md	RTL Generator Guide	Generator architecture, usage, customization, advanced topics

Supporting Documentation

Document	Location	Description
PRD.md	../PRD.md	Complete product requirements document

Document	Location	Description
CLAUDE.md	../CLAUDE.md	AI assistant integration guide
README.md	../README.md	Quick start guide

Visual Assets

Architecture Diagrams

Diagram	Format	Description
apbx_xbar_architecture	Graphviz	2x4 crossbar showing master-side slaves, arbitration, slave-side masters
address_decode_flow	Graphviz	Step-by-step address decode example (0x10023456 → Slave 2)

Rendered Formats: - PNG: assets/svg/*.svg (for markdown embedding) - SVG: assets/svg/*.svg (for web viewing, scalable)

Timing Diagrams

Diagram	Format	Description
arbitration_round_robin	WaveJSON	2 masters competing for Slave 0 with round-robin arbitration

Rendered Format: - PNG: assets/svg/arbitration_round_robin.svg

Quick Start

For New Users

- 1. Understand the Architecture**
 - Read [01_architecture.md](#)
 - Study the architecture diagram
 - Understand master-side/slave-side protocol conversion
- 2. Learn Address Decode & Arbitration**
 - Read [02_address_and_arbitration.md](#)
 - Study address decode flow diagram
 - Study arbitration timing diagram

3. Generate Custom Crossbar (if needed)

- Read [03_rtl_generator.md](#)
- Use pre-generated variants (1to1, 2to1, 1to4, 2to4) if possible
- Run generator for custom MxN configurations

4. Integrate Into Your Design

- See integration examples in [CLAUDE.md](#)
- Reference complete specification in [PRD.md](#)

For Existing Users

Need a Crossbar? - 1 master, N slaves → Use `apbx_xbar_1toN` or generate - 2 masters, N slaves → Use `apbx_xbar_2toN` or generate - M masters, N slaves → Generate with `generate_xbars.py`

Understanding Behavior? - Address decode issues → See [02_address_and_arbitration.md](#) - Arbitration questions → See [02_address_and_arbitration.md](#)

Modifying/Generating? - Generator usage → See [03_rtl_generator.md](#)

Directory Structure

docs/apbx_xbar_mas/	
├── README.md	← This file
├── apbx_xbar_mas_index.md	← Book index (PDF build)
├── chapters/	
│ ├── 01_architecture.md	← Architecture overview
│ └── 02_address_and_arbitration.md	← Decode & arbitration
├── details	
│ └── 03_rtl_generator.md	← Generator documentation
└── assets/	
├── graphviz/	← Source diagrams
│ ├── apbx_xbar_architecture.gv	
│ └── address_decode_flow.gv	
├── wavedrom/	← Source timing diagrams
│ └── arbitration_round_robin.json	
├── svg/	← Rendered SVG (scalable)
│ ├── apbx_xbar_architecture.svg	
│ └── address_decode_flow.svg	
└── png/	← Rendered PNG (embedded)
├── apbx_xbar_architecture.png	
└── address_decode_flow.png	

Key Concepts

1. Architecture

Three-Stage Design: 1. **Master-Side:** APB slaves convert protocol → cmd/rsp 2. **Internal Logic:** Address decode + arbitration + response routing 3. **Slave-Side:** APB masters convert cmd/rsp → protocol

Why This Design? - Reuses proven apb4_slave and apb4_master components - Clean separation of concerns - Scalable to any MxN configuration

2. Address Decode

Fixed 64KB Per Slave:

Slave 0: BASE_ADDR + 0x00000 - 0x0FFFF
Slave 1: BASE_ADDR + 0x10000 - 0x1FFFF
Slave 2: BASE_ADDR + 0x20000 - 0x2FFFF
...

Decode Formula:

```
offset = PADDR - BASE_ADDR  
slave_index = offset[19:16] // Divide by 64KB
```

See: [02_address_and_arbitration.md](#)

3. Arbitration

Per-Slave Round-Robin: - Each slave has independent arbiter - Priority rotates after each grant - Grant persists through transaction completion - No master starvation

See: [02_address_and_arbitration.md](#)

4. RTL Generation

All Generator Code in Component Area: - **Convenience Wrapper:** bin/generate_xbars.py (top-level script) - **Core Generator:** bin/apbx_xbar_generator.py (library implementation)

Usage:

```
# Generate standard variants  
python generate_xbars.py
```

```
# Generate custom 3x6 crossbar  
python generate_xbars.py --masters 3 --slaves 6
```

See: [03_rtl_generator.md](#)

Common Questions

Q: Which pre-generated variant should I use?

Decision Tree:

1 master, 1 slave → apbx_xbar_1to1 (passthrough)
1 master, 4 slaves → apbx_xbar_1to4 (address decode only)
2 masters, 1 slave → apbx_xbar_2to1 (arbitration only)
2 masters, 4 slaves → apbx_xbar_2to4 (full crossbar)
Other MxN → Generate with generate_xbars.py

Q: How do I change the base address?

At Instantiation:

```
apbx_xbar_1to4 #(
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h8000_0000) // Override default 0x10000000
) u_xbar (...);
```

Or Generate with Custom Base:

```
python generate_xbars.py --masters 2 --slaves 4 --base-addr 0x80000000
```

Q: Can I change per-slave address sizes?

No (Current Limitation): Each slave is fixed at 64KB.

Workarounds: 1. Use multiple crossbars with different BASE_ADDR 2. Modify generator's decode logic (advanced) 3. Address translation in slaves

See: [03_rtl_generator.md#limitations](#)

Q: How does arbitration work with 3+ masters?

Round-Robin Example (4 Masters, Same Slave):

Initial priority: M0

Transaction 1: M0 requests → M0 granted → Priority rotates to M1

Transaction 2: M0, M1, M2 request → M1 granted → Priority rotates to M2

Transaction 3: M0, M3 request → M2 skipped (not requesting) → M3 granted → Priority rotates to M0

Transaction 4: M0, M1 request → M0 granted → Priority rotates to M1

Key: Priority rotates after each grant, ensuring fairness.

See: [02_address_and_arbitration.md#arbitration](#)

Q: What's the throughput?

Single Master: - Zero-bubble (back-to-back transactions without gaps) - Limited only by slave PREADY response time

Multiple Masters (Same Slave): - Fair sharing: Each master gets $\sim 1/M$ bandwidth - Example: 2 masters = 50% each, 4 masters = 25% each

Multiple Masters (Different Slaves): - Full parallelism: Each master gets 100% of its target slave - Total system bandwidth = $\text{NUM_SLAVES} \times \text{slave_bandwidth}$

See: [02_address_and_arbitration.md#performance](#)

Regenerating Diagrams

Graphviz Diagrams (Architecture, Address Decode)

```
cd assets/graphviz/
```

```
# Generate SVG
```

```
dot -Tsvg apbx_xbar_architecture.gv -o  
../svg/apbx_xbar_architecture.svg  
dot -Tsvg address_decode_flow.gv -o ../svg/address_decode_flow.svg
```

```
# Generate PNG
```

```
dot -Tsvg apbx_xbar_architecture.gv -o  
../svg/apbx_xbar_architecture.svg  
dot -Tsvg address_decode_flow.gv -o ../svg/address_decode_flow.svg
```

WaveJSON Diagrams (Timing)

```
cd assets/wavedrom/
```

```
# Generate PNG
```

```
wavedrom-cli -i arbitration_round_robin.json -s  
../svg/arbitration_round_robin.svg
```

Version History

Version 1.0 (2025-10-25): - Initial visual documentation release - 3 main documentation files - 2 Graphviz architecture diagrams - 1 WaveJSON timing diagram - RTL generator documentation

Maintainers

RTL Design Sherpa Project

Questions or Issues: 1. Check this documentation first 2. Review [PRD.md](#) for complete specification 3. Review [CLAUDE.md](#) for integration guidance 4. Open GitHub issue if problem persists

Last Updated: 2025-10-25 **Version:** 1.0 **Status:** Production Ready

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APB Crossbar Architecture

Component: APB Crossbar (MxN Interconnect) **Version:** 1.0 **Status:** Production Ready

Overview

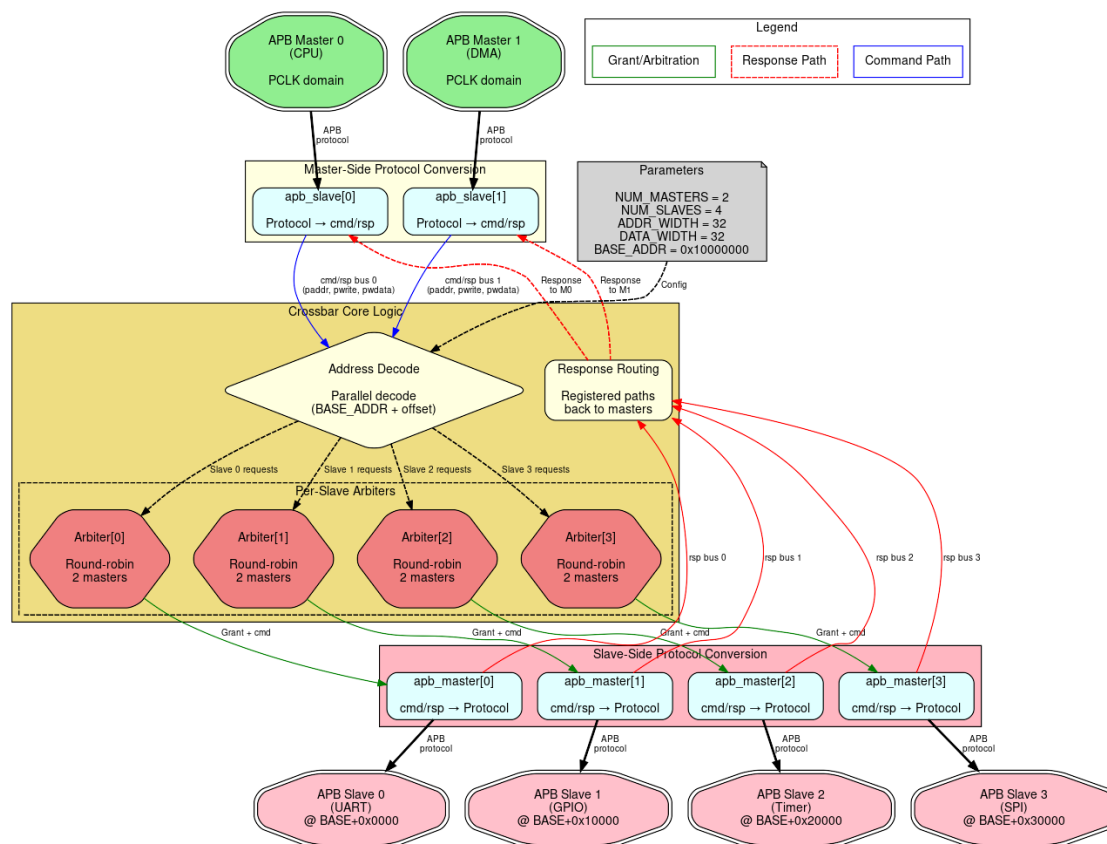
The APB Crossbar is a parametric interconnect that connects M APB masters to N APB slaves with automatic address-based routing and per-slave round-robin arbitration. Built from proven `apb4_slave` and `apb4_master` components, the crossbar provides a clean, scalable solution for SoC peripheral interconnect.

Key Features: - Arbitrary MxN configuration (up to 16x16) - Automatic address decode (64KB per slave) - Round-robin arbitration per slave - Zero-bubble throughput - Grant persistence through transaction completion

Architecture Diagram

The following diagram shows a 2x4 crossbar configuration connecting 2 masters (CPU and DMA) to 4 slaves (UART, GPIO, Timer, SPI):

Figure 1.1: APB Crossbar Top-Level Architecture



APB Crossbar Architecture (2x4 Example)

The figure shows 2 masters connected to 4 slaves via master-side protocol conversion, internal arbitration logic, and slave-side protocol conversion.

Functional Blocks

1. Master-Side Protocol Conversion

Component: apb4_slave[M] instances (one per master)

Purpose: Convert incoming APB protocol transactions to internal cmd/rsp bus format

Features: - Full APB protocol handling (PSEL, PENABLE, PREADY) - Transaction buffering - Error response generation - Back-to-back transaction support

Dataflow:

APB Master → apb4_slave → cmd/rsp bus → Internal Crossbar Logic

2. Internal Crossbar Logic

Components: - **Address Decode** - Parallel decode to determine target slave - **Per-Slave Arbiters** - Round-robin arbitration for each slave - **Response Routing** - Registered paths back to requesting masters

Key Operations:

Address Decode:

```
offset = PADDR - BASE_ADDR  
slave_index = offset[19:16] // Upper 4 bits of 20-bit offset (64KB regions)
```

Arbitration: - Independent arbiter per slave - Round-robin priority rotation - Grant persistence through response - No starvation guarantee

Response Routing: - Track which master initiated each transaction - Route PRDATA/PSLVERR back to originating master - Maintain transaction ordering per master

3. Slave-Side Protocol Conversion

Component: apb4_master[N] instances (one per slave)

Purpose: Convert internal cmd/rsp bus format back to APB protocol for slaves

Features: - APB protocol generation (PSEL, PENABLE timing) - Response collection (PRDATA, PSLVERR, PREADY) - Wait state handling - Error propagation

Dataflow:

Internal Crossbar Logic → cmd/rsp bus → apb4_master → APB Slave

Signal Flow Example

Transaction: Master 0 (CPU) writes to Slave 2 (Timer) at address 0x10023456

Step-by-step:

1. Master 0 → apb4_slave[0]:

- CPU asserts PSEL, PADDR=0x10023456, PWRITE=1
- apb4_slave[0] converts to cmd/rsp format

2. Address Decode:

- offset = 0x10023456 - 0x10000000 = 0x00023456
- slave_index = 0x00023456 >> 16 = 0x2
- Target: Slave 2

3. Arbiter[2]:

- Check if Slave 2 is available
- Grant to Master 0 (if no conflict)
- Route cmd to apb4_master[2]

4. apb4_master[2] → Slave 2:

- Generate APB write transaction
- Assert PSEL[2], PENABLE, PADDR, PWDATA
- Wait for PREADY

5. Response Path:

- Slave 2 responds with PREADY, PSLVERR
- apb4_master[2] captures response
- Response routed back to apb4_slave[0]
- apb4_slave[0] returns PREADY to CPU

Total Latency: Typically 2-3 cycles for uncontended access

Parameter Configuration

Top-Level Parameters:

Top-Level Parameters

Parameter	Range	Default	Description
NUM_MASTERS	1-16	2	Number of APB masters
NUM_SLAVES	1-16	4	Number of APB slaves
ADDR_WIDTH	8-64	32	Address bus width
DATA_WIDTH	8-64	32	Data bus width
BASE_ADDR	Any	0x10000000	Base address for address map

Derived Parameters: - Slave address range: 64KB (0x10000) per slave - Total address space: $\text{NUM_SLAVES} \times 64\text{KB}$

Pre-Generated Variants

Pre-Generated Crossbar Variants

Module	M×N	LOC	Use Case
apbx_xbar_1to1	1×1	~200	Passthrough, protocol conversion
apbx_xbar_2to1	2×1	~400	Multi-master arbitration
apbx_xbar_1to4	1×4	~500	Simple SoC peripheral bus
apbx_xbar_2to4	2×4	~1000	Typical SoC with CPU+DMA
apbx_xbar_thin	1×1	~150	Minimal overhead passthrough

Custom Variants: Generated on-demand via Python script

Design Philosophy

Proven Components: - Built from production-tested `apb4_slave.sv` and `apb4_master.sv` - No new protocol logic - pure composition - Each component independently verified

Scalability: - Parametric generation for any M×N configuration - Resource usage scales linearly with M×N - No centralized bottlenecks

Predictability: - Round-robin arbitration provides deterministic behavior - Fixed address map simplifies software integration - Zero-bubble design ensures maximum throughput

Next Steps

- See [Address Decode and Arbitration](#) for detailed operation examples

- See [PRD.md](#) for complete specification
 - See [CLAUDE.md](#) for integration guidance
 - See [README.md](#) for quick start guide
-

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Address Decode and Arbitration

Component: APB Crossbar (MxN Interconnect) **Version:** 1.0 **Status:** Production Ready

Overview

This document details the two core mechanisms of the APB Crossbar: 1. **Address Decode** - How incoming addresses map to specific slaves 2. **Arbitration** - How multiple masters share access to the same slave

Address Decode

Address Map Structure

The crossbar uses a fixed 64KB (0x10000 bytes) region per slave:

```
BASE_ADDR + 0x0000_0000 → 0x0000_FFFF : Slave 0 (64KB)
BASE_ADDR + 0x0001_0000 → 0x0001_FFFF : Slave 1 (64KB)
BASE_ADDR + 0x0002_0000 → 0x0002_FFFF : Slave 2 (64KB)
BASE_ADDR + 0x0003_0000 → 0x0003_FFFF : Slave 3 (64KB)
...
BASE_ADDR + 0x000F_0000 → 0x000F_FFFF : Slave 15 (64KB)
```

Default BASE_ADDR: 0x10000000

Total Address Space: NUM_SLAVES × 64KB

Decode Algorithm

The crossbar extracts the slave index from the upper bits of the address offset:

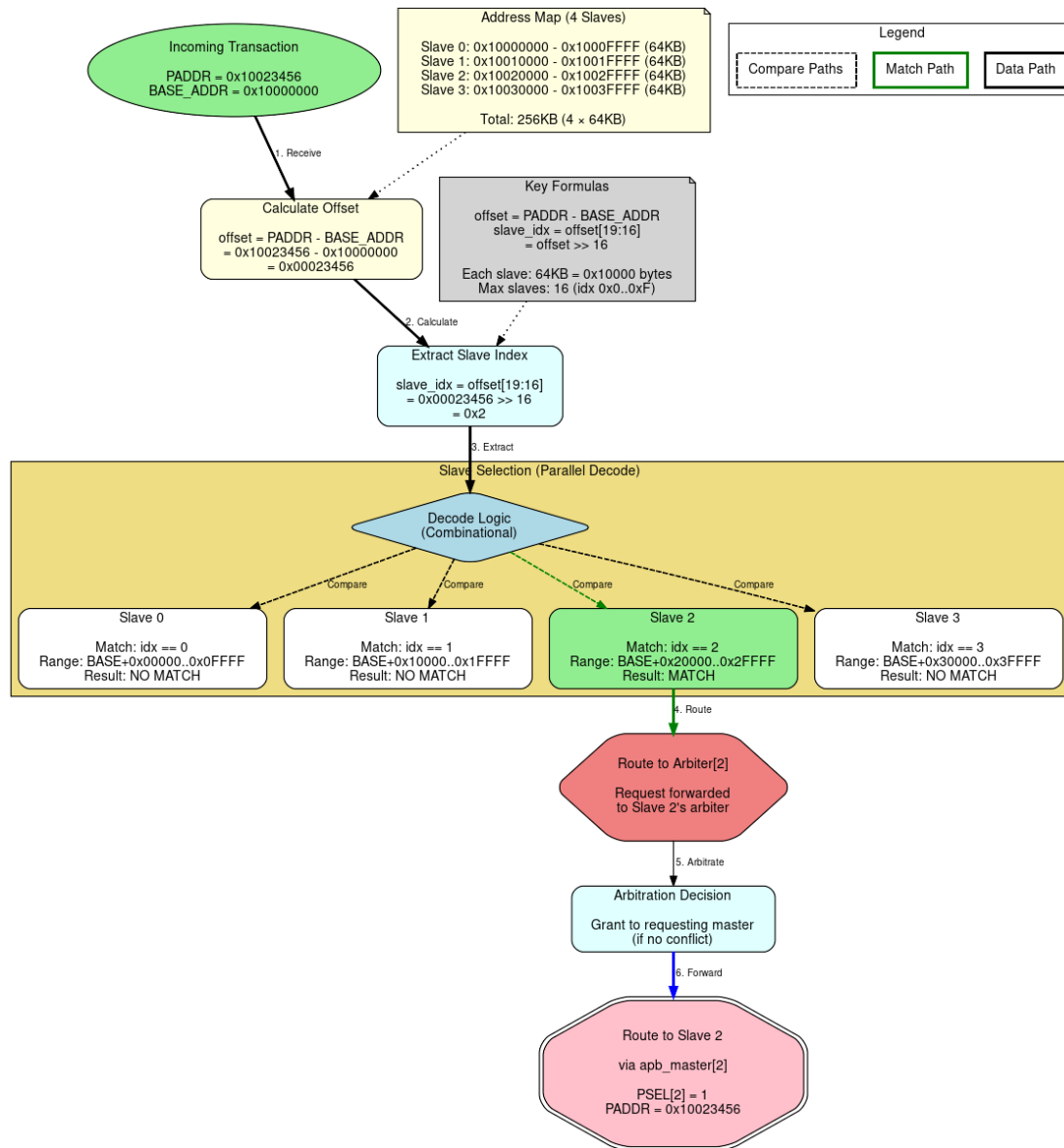
```
offset = PADDR - BASE_ADDR  
slave_index = offset[19:16] // Upper 4 bits of 20-bit offset
```

Why offset[19:16]? - 64KB = 0x10000 = 2^{16} bytes - Lower 16 bits (offset[15:0]) are byte address within slave - Upper 4 bits (offset[19:16]) select which of 16 slaves - Supports up to 16 slaves (0x0 through 0xF)

Address Decode Flow Diagram

The following diagram shows a concrete example of how address 0x10023456 routes to Slave 2:

Figure 2.1: Address Decode Flow



Address Decode Flow

The figure shows step-by-step routing of address 0x10023456 to Slave 2.

Decode Example Walkthrough

Scenario: Master accesses address 0x10023456 with BASE_ADDR = 0x10000000

Step 1: Calculate Offset

```
offset = PADDR - BASE_ADDR
        = 0x10023456 - 0x10000000
        = 0x00023456
```

Step 2: Extract Slave Index

```
slave_index = offset[19:16]
            = 0x00023456 >> 16
            = 0x2
```

Step 3: Parallel Decode

The crossbar checks all slave ranges in parallel: - Slave 0: 0x00000 - 0x0FFFF → NO MATCH - Slave 1: 0x10000 - 0x1FFFF → NO MATCH - **Slave 2: 0x20000 - 0x2FFFF → MATCH** ✓ - Slave 3: 0x30000 - 0x3FFFF → NO MATCH

Step 4: Route to Arbiter

Transaction request forwarded to Arbiter[2] (Slave 2's arbiter)

Step 5: Forward to Slave

After arbitration grant, transaction forwarded via apb4_master[2] to physical Slave 2

Final Address Sent to Slave: 0x10023456 (full address preserved)

Multiple Address Maps

You can create multiple distinct address maps by using different BASE_ADDR values:

Example: Two Crossbars

```
// Peripheral Bus: 0x1000_0000 - 0x1003_FFFF
apbx_xbar_lto4 #(
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h1000_0000)
) u_periph_xbar (...);
// Slaves at: 0x1000_0000, 0x1001_0000, 0x1002_0000, 0x1003_0000

// Memory-Mapped I/O: 0x8000_0000 - 0x8003_FFFF
apbx_xbar_lto4 #(
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h8000_0000)
) u_mmio_xbar (...);
// Slaves at: 0x8000_0000, 0x8001_0000, 0x8002_0000, 0x8003_0000
```

Arbitration

Per-Slave Round-Robin

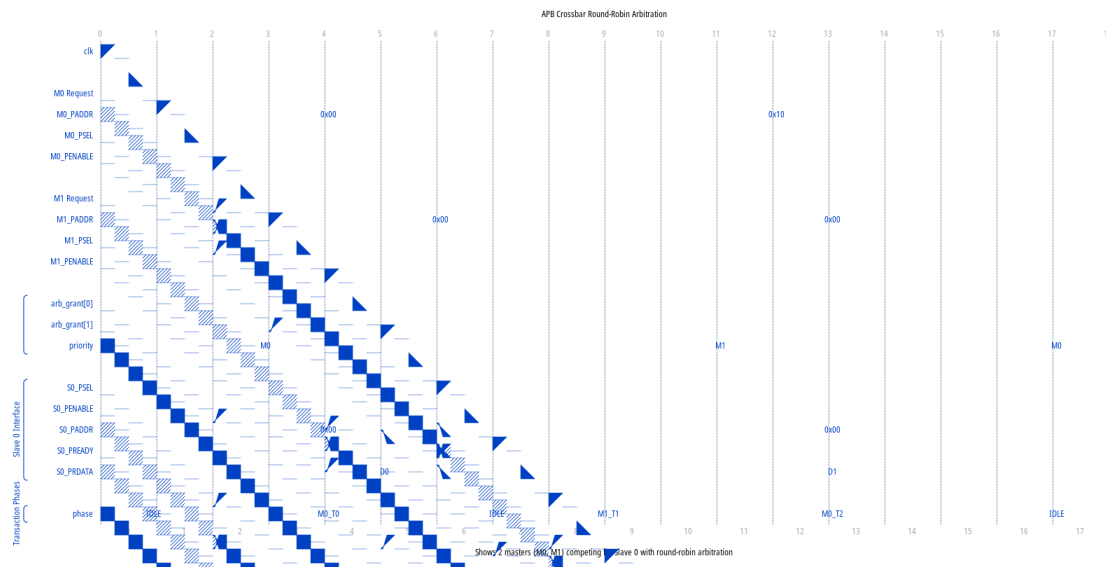
Each slave has an **independent arbiter** that implements round-robin scheduling:

Key Properties: - **Fair:** No master can starve another - **Independent:** Each slave arbitrates separately - **Predictable:** Priority rotates after each grant - **Persistent:** Grant held from command through response

Round-Robin Timing Diagram

The following timing diagram shows 2 masters (M0, M1) competing for access to Slave 0:

Waveform 2.1: Round-Robin Arbitration Timing



Round-Robin Arbitration Timing

Arbitration Example Walkthrough

Scenario: Master 0 and Master 1 both want to access Slave 0

Initial State: - Priority: M0 (M0 has priority initially) - Slave 0: IDLE

Transaction 1: M0 Requests Slave 0

Cycle 1: M0 asserts request (M0_PSEL, M0_PADDR=0x1000_0000)

Cycle 2: Arbiter[0] grants to M0 (only requester)

M0_PENABLE asserted

S0_PSEL asserted to Slave 0

Cycle 3: Slave 0 responds (S0_PREADY)

Transaction completes
Priority rotates: M1 now has priority

Transaction 2: M0 and M1 Both Request Slave 0

Cycle 4: M0 asserts request (M0_PADDR=0x1000_0010)
M1 asserts request (M1_PADDR=0x1000_0000) -- CONFLICT!
Cycle 5: Arbiter[0] grants to M1 (has priority)
M1_PENABLE asserted
S0_PSEL asserted to Slave 0
M0 blocked, waits
Cycle 6: Slave 0 responds (S0_PREADY)
M1 transaction completes
Priority rotates: M0 now has priority

Transaction 3: M0 Request (After Rotation)

Cycle 7: M0 still asserting request (was blocked)
Cycle 8: Arbiter[0] grants to M0 (now has priority)
M0_PENABLE asserted
S0_PSEL asserted to Slave 0
Cycle 9: Slave 0 responds (S0_PREADY)
Transaction completes
Priority rotates: M1 now has priority

Result: Fair access - each master gets served in turn when both request

Multi-Slave Parallelism

Key Feature: Different slaves can be accessed simultaneously by different masters

Example: Parallel Transactions

Time T0:

- Master 0 accesses Slave 0 (UART) - GRANTED
- Master 1 accesses Slave 2 (Timer) - GRANTED

Both transactions proceed in parallel (no conflict)

Time T1:

- Master 0 accesses Slave 0 (UART) - GRANTED
- Master 1 accesses Slave 0 (UART) - BLOCKED (arbitration)

Master 1 waits for Master 0 to complete

Time T2:

- Master 0 completes, releases Slave 0
- Master 1 accesses Slave 0 (UART) - GRANTED

Priority rotated for Slave 0's arbiter

Benefit: Maximum throughput when masters access different slaves

Grant Persistence

Critical Property: Once granted, a master holds the slave until response completes

Why This Matters:

WITHOUT Grant Persistence:

- Master 0 granted Slave 0
- Master 0 asserts PENABLE
- *Grant could change here* ← BREAKS PROTOCOL!
- Slave 0 responds to wrong master

WITH Grant Persistence:

- Master 0 granted Slave 0
- Master 0 asserts PENABLE
- Grant held until PREADY asserted ← SAFE
- Slave 0 responds to correct master
- Grant released for next transaction

Implementation: Grant signal registered and held from PSEL assertion through PREADY response

Arbitration Latency

Best Case (No Contention): - 0 cycles arbitration delay - Request → Grant in same cycle - APB protocol overhead: 2 cycles minimum (PSEL + PENABLE)

Worst Case (Maximum Contention): - M-1 cycles wait time (other masters ahead in round-robin)
- Example: 2 masters, worst case = 1 cycle wait - Example: 4 masters, worst case = 3 cycles wait

Average Case (Random Access Pattern): - (M-1)/2 cycles average wait time - Statistical fairness over time

Integration Examples

Example 1: CPU to 4 Peripherals (No Contention)

```
apbx_xbar_lto4 #(
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h1000_0000)
) u_periph_xbar (
    // Single master (CPU)
    .m0_apb_* (cpu_apb_*),

    // 4 slaves (UART, GPIO, Timer, SPI)
    .s0_apb_* (uart_*),    // 0x1000_0000
    .s1_apb_* (gpio_*),    // 0x1001_0000
    .s2_apb_* (timer_*),   // 0x1002_0000
```

```

        .s3_apb_* (spi_*)           // 0x1003_0000
    );

```

Behavior: - No arbitration needed (single master) - Pure address decode functionality - Zero arbitration overhead

Example 2: CPU + DMA to 4 Peripherals (Potential Contention)

```

apbx_xbar_2to4 #(
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h4000_0000)
) u_soc_xbar (
    // Two masters
    .m0_apb_* (cpu_apb_*),
    .m1_apb_* (dma_apb_*),

    // 4 slaves
    .s0_apb_* (mem_ctrl_*), // 0x4000_0000
    .s1_apb_* (uart_*),     // 0x4001_0000
    .s2_apb_* (i2c_*),      // 0x4002_0000
    .s3_apb_* (adc_*)       // 0x4003_0000
);

```

Behavior: - Each slave has independent arbiter - CPU and DMA can access different slaves simultaneously - If both access same slave, round-robin arbitration - Fair access guaranteed

Performance Characteristics

Throughput

Single Master: - Back-to-back transactions supported - Zero bubble (no idle cycles between transactions) - Limited only by slave PREADY response time

Multiple Masters (Same Slave): - Round-robin introduces fair sharing - Each master gets ~1/M of bandwidth - Example: 2 masters = 50% bandwidth each

Multiple Masters (Different Slaves): - Full parallelism - Each master gets 100% of its target slave
 - Total system bandwidth = NUM_SLAVES × slave_bandwidth

Latency

Components:

1. **Address Decode:** 0 cycles (combinational, parallel)
2. **Arbitration Decision:** 0 cycles (combinational)
3. **APB Protocol:** 2 cycles minimum (PSEL + PENABLE)
4. **Slave Response:** Variable (depends on slave)

Total Minimum Latency: 2 cycles (uncontended access)

With Contention: +1 to +(M-1) cycles arbitration wait time

Design Notes

Why 64KB Per Slave?

Rationale: - Sufficient for most APB peripherals (typically 256B - 4KB register space) - Simple decode logic (single shift operation) - Allows up to 16 slaves with clean byte alignment - Software-friendly (each peripheral has “round” base address)

Alternatives: - Smaller regions (4KB, 16KB) → more slaves, more complex decode - Larger regions (256KB, 1MB) → fewer slaves, wasted address space

Why Round-Robin?

Advantages: - Fair: Prevents starvation - Simple: Minimal logic (counter + comparator) - Predictable: Software can reason about worst-case latency - No configuration: Works out-of-box

Alternatives: - Fixed priority → Can starve low-priority masters - Weighted fair queuing → More complex, requires configuration - Lottery scheduling → Unpredictable, harder to verify

Troubleshooting

Issue: Wrong Slave Selected

Check: 1. BASE_ADDR parameter correct? 2. Address within expected range? 3. Calculated slave_index matches expectation?

Debug:

```
offset = PADDR - BASE_ADDR
slave_index = offset >> 16
expected_slave = slave_index // Should match actual PSEL
```

Issue: Master Starved

Check: 1. Other masters continuously accessing same slave? 2. Arbitration timeout monitoring enabled? 3. Round-robin priority rotating correctly?

Expected Behavior: - Each master should get grant within M transactions - No master should wait indefinitely

Issue: Back-to-Back Transactions Stalling

Check: 1. Grant persistence working? 2. Slave asserting PREADY correctly? 3. No unintended pipeline bubbles?

Expected Behavior: - Consecutive transactions from same master should flow without gaps - Only arbitration conflicts should introduce wait states

Next Steps

- See [Architecture](#) for top-level design overview
 - See [PRD.md](#) for complete specification
 - See [CLAUDE.md](#) for integration guidance
 - See [README.md](#) for quick start guide
-

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APB Crossbar RTL Generator

Component: APB Crossbar (MxN Interconnect) **Version:** 1.0 **Status:** Production Ready

Overview

The APB Crossbar uses **parametric RTL generation** to create custom MxN configurations. While several pre-generated variants exist (1to1, 2to1, 1to4, 2to4, thin), the Python-based generator enables creation of any arbitrary MxN crossbar up to 16x16.

Philosophy: - Pre-generated variants for common use cases (fast integration) - Python generator for custom configurations (flexibility) - Template-based code generation (consistency) - Built from proven components (quality)

Generator Architecture

Two-Level Structure

```
projects/components/apbx-xbar/  
├── bin/  
│   └── generate_xbars.py           ← Convenience wrapper script  
└── (repo root)/bin/rtl_generators/amba/  
    └── apbx_xbar_generator.py      ← Core generator engine
```

Why Two Files? 1. **Core Generator** (`apbx_xbar_generator.py`): Reusable library function - Can be imported by other scripts - Contains `generate_apbx_xbar()` function - Located in central `bin/rtl_generators/` directory

2. **Convenience Wrapper** (`generate_xbars.py`): Project-specific script

- Easy command-line interface
 - Pre-configured for standard variants
 - Located in project `bin/` directory
-

Quick Start

Generate Standard Variants (1:1, 2:1, 1:4, 2:4)

```
cd projects/components/apbx-xbar/bin/  
python generate_xbars.py
```

Output:

```
Generating 1-to-1 crossbar...
```

```
✓ apbx_xbar_1to1.sv
```

```
Generating 2-to-1 crossbar...
```

```
✓ apbx_xbar_2to1.sv
```

```
Generating 1-to-4 crossbar...
```

```
✓ apbx_xbar_1to4.sv
```

```
Generating 2-to-4 crossbar...
```

```
✓ apbx_xbar_2to4.sv
```

```
✓ Generated 4 crossbar variants
```

Generate Custom Variant

```
cd projects/components/apbx-xbar/bin/  
python generate_xbars.py --masters 3 --slaves 6
```

Output:

Generating 3-to-6 crossbar...
✓ Generated apbx_xbar_3to6.sv

Generate with Custom Base Address

```
cd projects/components/apbx-xbar/bin/  
python generate_xbars.py --masters 4 --slaves 8 --base-addr 0x80000000
```

Output:

Generating 4-to-8 crossbar...
✓ Generated apbx_xbar_4to8.sv

Address Map:

Slave 0: [0x80000000, 0x8000FFFF]
Slave 1: [0x80010000, 0x8001FFFF]
Slave 2: [0x80020000, 0x8002FFFF]
...
Slave 7: [0x80070000, 0x8007FFFF]

Command-Line Interface

Full Options

```
python generate_xbars.py [OPTIONS]
```

Options:

Command Line Options

Option	Short	Type	Default	Description
--masters	-m	int	None	Number of master interfaces (1-16)
--slaves	-s	int	None	Number of slave interfaces (1-16)
--base-addr	-b	hex	0x10000000	Base address for slave address map
--help	-h	-	-	Show help message

Rules: - If neither --masters nor --slaves specified → Generate all standard variants - If only one specified → Error (must specify both) - If both specified → Generate custom variant

Examples

Example 1: Generate All Standard Variants

```
python generate_xbars.py
```

Example 2: Generate 3x6 Crossbar

```
python generate_xbars.py --masters 3 --slaves 6
```

Example 3: Generate 5x10 Crossbar with Custom Base

```
python generate_xbars.py -m 5 -s 10 -b 0xA0000000
```

Example 4: Show Help

```
python generate_xbars.py --help
```

Generated Code Structure

Template Components

The generator creates a complete SystemVerilog module with:

1. Header with Address Map

```
// 3-to-6 APB crossbar with address decoding and arbitration
// 3 masters to 6 slaves using apb4_slave and apb4_master modules
//
// Address Map (same for all masters):
//   Slave 0: [0x10000000, 0x1000FFFF]
//   Slave 1: [0x10010000, 0x1001FFFF]
//   Slave 2: [0x10020000, 0x1002FFFF]
//   Slave 3: [0x10030000, 0x1003FFFF]
//   Slave 4: [0x10040000, 0x1004FFFF]
//   Slave 5: [0x10050000, 0x1005FFFF]
```

2. Module Declaration with Parameters

```
module apbx_xbar_3to6 #(
    parameter int ADDR_WIDTH = 32,
    parameter int DATA_WIDTH = 32,
    parameter int STRB_WIDTH = DATA_WIDTH / 8,
    parameter logic [ADDR_WIDTH-1:0] BASE_ADDR = 32'h10000000
) (
    // Clock and Reset
    input logic                                pclk,
    input logic                                presetn,

    // Master 0-2 APB interfaces
    // Slave 0-5 APB interfaces
);
```

3. Internal Signal Declarations

```
// Command/Response interfaces for master 0-2 apb4_slave
logic m0_cmd_valid, m0_cmd_ready, m0_cmd_pwrite;
logic [ADDR_WIDTH-1:0] m0_cmd_paddr;
// ... (full cmd/rsp bus for each master)

// Command/Response interfaces for slave 0-5 apb4_master
logic s0_cmd_valid, s0_cmd_ready, s0_cmd_pwrite;
logic [ADDR_WIDTH-1:0] s0_cmd_paddr;
// ... (full cmd/rsp bus for each slave)
```

4. Master-Side apb4_slave Instantiations

```
// Master 0 apb4_slave
apb4_slave #(
    .ADDR_WIDTH(ADDR_WIDTH),
    .DATA_WIDTH(DATA_WIDTH)
) u_m0_slave (
    .pclk(pclk),
    .presetn(presetn),
    // APB interface
    .apb_PSEL(m0_apb_PSEL),
    .apb_PENABLE(m0_apb_PENABLE),
    // ... (full APB connections)
    // cmd/rsp interface
    .cmd_valid(m0_cmd_valid),
    .cmd_ready(m0_cmd_ready),
    // ... (full cmd/rsp connections)
);

// Master 1, 2 apb4_slave instances...
```

5. Address Decode Logic

```
// Address decode for each master
logic [M-1:0][N-1:0] m_to_s_req; // Request matrix

// Master 0 address decode
always_comb begin
    m_to_s_req[0] = '0;
    if (m0_cmd_valid) begin
        logic [ADDR_WIDTH-1:0] offset = m0_cmd_paddr - BASE_ADDR;
        logic [3:0] slave_idx = offset[19:16];
        case (slave_idx)
            4'd0: m_to_s_req[0][0] = 1'b1;
            4'd1: m_to_s_req[0][1] = 1'b1;
            // ... (case for each slave)
        endcase
    end
```

end

// Master 1, 2 address decode...

6. Per-Slave Arbitration Logic

```
// Arbitration for each slave
logic [N-1:0][M-1:0] s_grant; // Grant matrix
logic [N-1:0][$clog2(M)-1:0] s_arb_priority; // Round-robin
priority
```

```
// Slave 0 arbiter (round-robin among M masters)
always_ff @(posedge pclk or negedge presetn) begin
    if (!presetn) begin
        s_arb_priority[0] <= '0;
        s_grant[0] <= '0;
    end else begin
        // Round-robin arbitration logic
        // Priority rotation after each grant
    end
end
```

// Slave 1-5 arbiters...

7. Response Routing Logic

```
// Route responses back to requesting masters
always_comb begin
    // Track which master initiated each transaction
    // Route PRDATA/PSLVERR back to correct master
end
```

8. Slave-Side apb4_master Instantiations

```
// Slave 0 apb4_master
apb4_master #(
    .ADDR_WIDTH(ADDR_WIDTH),
    .DATA_WIDTH(DATA_WIDTH)
) u_s0_master (
    .pclk(pclk),
    .presetn(presetn),
    // cmd/rsp interface
    .cmd_valid(s0_cmd_valid),
    .cmd_ready(s0_cmd_ready),
    // ... (full cmd/rsp connections)
    // APB interface
    .apb_PSEL(s0_apb_PSEL),
    .apb_PENABLE(s0_apb_PENABLE),
    // ... (full APB connections)
);
```

```
// Slave 1-5 apb4_master instances...
```

9. Module End

```
endmodule : apbx_xbar_3to6
```

Generator Algorithm

Step-by-Step Process

1. Validate Parameters

```
if M < 1 or M > 16:
    raise ValueError("Number of masters must be 1-16, got {M}")
if N < 1 or N > 16:
    raise ValueError("Number of slaves must be 1-16, got {N}")
```

2. Calculate Derived Parameters

```
slave_addr_bits = max(1, math.ceil(math.log2(N))) # Bits for slave
index
strb_width = data_width // 8 # Byte strobe
width
module_name = f"apbx_xbar_{M}to{N}" # Module name
```

3. Generate Address Map Documentation

```
for s in range(N):
    addr_offset = s * 0x10000 # 64KB per slave
    addr_start = base_addr + addr_offset
    addr_end = addr_start + 0xFFFF
    # Generate comment: Slave S: [START, END]
```

4. Generate Module Declaration - Parameters: ADDR_WIDTH, DATA_WIDTH, STRB_WIDTH, BASE_ADDR - Ports: Clock, reset - Master interfaces: $M \times$ full APB interface - Slave interfaces: $N \times$ full APB interface

5. Generate Internal Signals - Master cmd/rsp buses: M sets - Slave cmd/rsp buses: N sets - Request matrix: $[M][N]$ - Grant matrix: $[N][M]$ - Priority counters: $[N]$

6. Instantiate Master-Side Components

```
for m in range(M):
    # Generate apb4_slave instance
    # Connect APB interface to external master m
    # Connect cmd/rsp to internal buses
```

7. Generate Address Decode Logic

```
for m in range(M):
    # For each master, decode address to slave index
    # offset = paddr - BASE_ADDR
    # slave_idx = offset[19:16] # Upper 4 bits
    # Set m_to_s_req[m][slave_idx] = 1
```

8. Generate Arbitration Logic

```
for s in range(N):
    # For each slave, arbitrate among M masters
    # Round-robin: priority rotates after each grant
    # Grant persistence: hold until transaction completes
```

9. Generate Response Routing

```
# Track transaction source (which master)
# Route responses back to originating master
```

10. Instantiate Slave-Side Components

```
for s in range(N):
    # Generate apb4_master instance
    # Connect cmd/rsp from internal buses
    # Connect APB interface to external slave s
```

11. Write Generated Code

```
with open(output_file, 'w') as f:
    f.write(generated_code)
```

Code Generation Patterns

Loop-Based Generation

Master Interfaces:

```
for m in range(M):
    code += f"    // Master {m} APB interface\n"
    code += f"    input logic m{m}_apb_PSEL,\n"
    code += f"    input logic m{m}_apb_PENABLE,\n"
    # ... (all APB signals for master m)
```

Slave Interfaces:

```
for s in range(N):
    code += f"    // Slave {s} APB interface\n"
    code += f"    output logic s{s}_apb_PSEL,\n"
```

```
code += f"    output logic s{s}_apb_PENABLE,\n"
# ... (all APB signals for slave s)
```

String Formatting

Hex Values:

```
code += f"    parameter logic [ADDR_WIDTH-1:0] BASE_ADDR =
{addr_width}'h{base_addr:08X}\n"
# Example: 32'h10000000
```

Address Map Comments:

```
addr_start = base_addr + (s * 0x10000)
code += f"//    Slave {s}: [0x{addr_start:08X}, 0x{addr_start +
0xFFFF:08X}]\n"
# Example: Slave 2: [0x10020000, 0x1002FFFF]
```

Customization Examples

Example 1: Large SoC with 10 Peripherals

Scenario: CPU + DMA need to access 10 peripherals

Command:

```
python generate_xbars.py --masters 2 --slaves 10
```

Generated File: apbx_xbar_2to10.sv

Address Map:

```
Slave 0: 0x10000000 - 0x1000FFFF (UART0)
Slave 1: 0x10010000 - 0x1001FFFF (UART1)
Slave 2: 0x10020000 - 0x1002FFFF (GPIO)
Slave 3: 0x10030000 - 0x1003FFFF (I2C)
Slave 4: 0x10040000 - 0x1004FFFF (SPI)
Slave 5: 0x10050000 - 0x1005FFFF (Timer0)
Slave 6: 0x10060000 - 0x1006FFFF (Timer1)
Slave 7: 0x10070000 - 0x1007FFFF (PWM)
Slave 8: 0x10080000 - 0x1008FFFF (ADC)
Slave 9: 0x10090000 - 0x1009FFFF (Watchdog)
```

LOC: ~2500 lines (estimated)

Example 2: Multi-CPU System

Scenario: 4 CPUs accessing shared peripheral bus with 4 slaves

Command:

```
python generate_xbars.py --masters 4 --slaves 4
```

Generated File: apbx_xbar_4to4.sv

Benefits: - Fair arbitration among 4 CPUs - Each slave independently arbitrated - Maximum throughput when CPUs access different slaves

LOC: ~1600 lines (estimated)

Example 3: Memory-Mapped I/O Region

Scenario: Single master accessing I/O region at 0xA0000000

Command:

```
python generate_xbars.py --masters 1 --slaves 8 --base-addr 0xA0000000
```

Generated File: apbx_xbar_1to8.sv

Address Map:

```
Slave 0: 0xA0000000 - 0xA000FFFF
Slave 1: 0xA0010000 - 0xA001FFFF
...
Slave 7: 0xA0070000 - 0xA007FFFF
```

Using Generated Modules

Integration Example

// Generated file: apbx_xbar_3to6.sv

```
module my_soc (
    input logic clk,
    input logic rst_n,
    // ... other interfaces
);

// Instantiate 3x6 crossbar
apbx_xbar_3to6 #(
    .ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .DATA_WIDTH(32),
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h10000000) // Can override at instantiation
) u_periph_xbar (
    .pclk(clk),
    .presetn(rst_n),
```

```

    // Connect 3 masters (CPU, DMA, Debug)
    .m0_apb_PSEL(cpu_apb_psel),
    .m0_apb_PENABLE(cpu_apb_penable),
    // ... (full CPU APB interface)

    .m1_apb_PSEL(dma_apb_psel),
    .m1_apb_PENABLE(dma_apb_penable),
    // ... (full DMA APB interface)

    .m2_apb_PSEL(debug_apb_psel),
    .m2_apb_PENABLE(debug_apb_penable),
    // ... (full Debug APB interface)

    // Connect 6 slaves (UART, GPIO, Timer, SPI, I2C, ADC)
    .s0_apb_PSEL(uart_psel),
    .s0_apb_PENABLE(uart_penable),
    // ... (full UART APB interface)

    .s1_apb_PSEL(gpio_psel),
    // ... (remaining slaves)
);

```

endmodule : my_soc

Parameter Override

```

// Use different base address at instantiation
apbx_xbar_3to6 #(
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h80000000) // Override default 0x10000000
) u_mmio_xbar (
    // ... connections
);
// Slaves now at: 0x80000000, 0x80010000, 0x80020000, ...

```

Generator Limitations and Future Work

Current Limitations

1. Fixed 64KB Per Slave

- Cannot customize individual slave region sizes
- Workaround: Use multiple crossbars with different BASE_ADDR

2. Max 16x16 Configuration

- Practical limit due to arbitration complexity
- Workaround: Hierarchical crossbars

3. Single Address Map

- All masters see same slave address map
- Workaround: Address translation before crossbar

4. No Priority Levels

- Round-robin only, no fixed priority or weighted arbitration
- Workaround: External priority arbitration before crossbar

Future Enhancements

1. Variable Slave Sizes

```
# Potential future API
generate_apbx_xbar(
    num_masters=2,
    slave_sizes=[4096, 65536, 1024, 16384], # Custom sizes per slave
    base_addr=0x10000000
)
```

2. Arbitration Policies

```
# Potential future API
generate_apbx_xbar(
    num_masters=4,
    num_slaves=4,
    arbitration="weighted", # "round-robin", "fixed-priority",
"weighted"
    weights=[4, 2, 1, 1] # Master 0 gets 4x priority
)
```

3. Address Translation

```
# Potential future API
generate_apbx_xbar(
    num_masters=2,
    num_slaves=4,
    master_views=[
        {"base": 0x00000000, "remap": True}, # Master 0 sees 0x0
        {"base": 0x10000000, "remap": False} # Master 1 sees
0x1000_0000
    ]
)
```

Testing Generated Code

Verification Flow

1. Generate Crossbar

```
python generate_xbars.py --masters 2 --slaves 4
```

2. Lint Generated RTL

```
cd ../../rtl/  
verilator --lint-only apbx_xbar_2to4.sv
```

3. Run Functional Tests

```
cd ../../dv/tests/  
pytest test_apbx_xbar_2to4.py -v
```

4. View Waveforms (If Test Fails)

```
gtkwave waves.vcd
```

Recommended Test Cases

1. **Single Master Access** - Verify basic routing
 2. **Multi-Master Contention** - Verify arbitration
 3. **Back-to-Back Transactions** - Verify zero-bubble throughput
 4. **Address Decode Boundary** - Verify slave selection at boundaries
 5. **Error Response Propagation** - Verify PSLVERR routing
-

Advanced Usage

Using as Python Library

```
# Import generator function  
from bin.rtl_generators.amba.apbx_xbar_generator import  
generate_apbx_xbar
```

```
# Generate crossbar programmatically  
code = generate_apbx_xbar(  
    num_masters=3,  
    num_slaves=8,  
    base_addr=0xA0000000,  
    addr_width=32,  
    data_width=32,  
    output_file="my_custom_xbar.sv"  
)
```

```

# Generated code is returned as string
print(f"Generated {len(code)} bytes of SystemVerilog code")

# Can also write to file manually
with open("custom_output.sv", "w") as f:
    f.write(code)

```

Batch Generation

```

# Generate multiple variants in one script
variants = [
    (1, 4, 0x100000000),
    (2, 4, 0x200000000),
    (3, 6, 0x300000000),
    (4, 8, 0x400000000),
]

for masters, slaves, base_addr in variants:
    code = generate_apbx_xbar(
        num_masters=masters,
        num_slaves=slaves,
        base_addr=base_addr,
        output_file=f"xbar_{masters}to{slaves}_0x{base_addr:08X}.sv"
    )
    print(f"✓ Generated xbar_{masters}to{slaves}_0x{base_addr:08X}.sv")

```

Troubleshooting

Issue: “ModuleNotFoundError: No module named ‘amba.apbx_xbar_generator’”

Cause: Python can’t find the core generator module

Solution:

```

# Verify generator exists
ls -la bin/apbx_xbar_generator.py

# Run from bin directory
cd projects/components/apbx-xbar/bin/
python generate_xbars.py

```

Issue: Generated Code Won't Lint

Cause: Generator bug or unsupported configuration

Solution: 1. Check parameter ranges (1-16 for M and N) 2. Verify base address alignment (should be aligned to $64\text{KB} \times N$) 3. Report bug with command that caused issue

Issue: Generated Code Too Large

Cause: Very large MxN configuration (e.g., 16x16)

Expected Behavior: - 1x1: ~200 LOC - 2x4: ~1000 LOC - 16x16: ~25,000 LOC (practical limit)

Solution: - Consider hierarchical approach (multiple smaller crossbars) - Or use different interconnect topology (bus, tree, etc.)

References

- [Architecture Overview](#)
 - [Address Decode and Arbitration](#)
 - [PRD.md](#) - Complete specification
 - [CLAUDE.md](#) - Integration guidance
 - [README.md](#) - Quick start guide
-

Version: 1.0 **Last Updated:** 2025-10-25 **Maintained By:** RTL Design Sherpa Project

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APB Crossbar Hardware Architecture Specification Index

Version: 1.0 **Date:** 2026-01-03 **Purpose:** High-level hardware architecture specification for APB Crossbar component

Document Organization

Note: All chapters linked below for automated document generation.

Front Matter

- [Document Information](#)

Chapter 1: Introduction

- [Purpose and Scope](#)
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- [Definitions and Acronyms](#)

Chapter 2: System Overview

- [Use Cases](#)
- [Key Features](#)
- [System Context](#)

Chapter 3: Architecture

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Chapter 5: Performance

- [Throughput Characteristics](#)
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- [Resource Estimates](#)

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- [System Requirements](#)
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-

Related Documentation

- [APB Crossbar MAS](#) - Micro-Architecture Specification (detailed block-level)

- [PRD.md](#) - Product requirements and overview
 - [CLAUDE.md](#) - AI development guide
-

Last Updated: 2026-01-03 **Maintained By:** RTL Design Sherpa Project

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Product Requirements Document (PRD)

APB Crossbar Generator

Version: 1.0 **Date:** 2025-10-19 **Status:** Production Ready **Owner:** RTL Design Sherpa Project
Parent Document: /PRD.md

1. Executive Summary

The **APB Crossbar** is a parametric APB interconnect generator that creates configurable MxN crossbar fabrics for connecting multiple APB masters to multiple APB slaves. Built using proven `apb4_slave` and `apb4_master` modules, the crossbar provides independent round-robin arbitration per slave and automatic address-based routing.

1.1 Quick Stats

- **Modules:** 5 pre-generated variants + generator for custom sizes
- **Max Capacity:** Up to 16x16 (configurable)
- **Architecture:** `apb4_slave` → arbitration + decode → `apb4_master`
- **Status:** Production ready, all tests passing
- **Generator:** Python-based parametric code generation

1.2 Project Goals

- **Primary:** Provide production-quality APB interconnect for SoC integration
 - **Secondary:** Demonstrate parametric RTL generation best practices
 - **Tertiary:** Support both fixed and dynamically-generated variants
-

2. Key Design Principles

2.1 Architecture Philosophy

Proven Building Blocks: - Uses `apb4_slave.sv` and `apb4_master.sv` from `rtl/amba/apb4` - Each module independently tested and production-proven - Crossbar = composition of proven components

Parametric Generation: - Generator creates any MxN configuration - Pre-generated common variants (1to1, 2to1, 1to4, 2to4, thin) - Custom variants generated on-demand

Clean Separation: - Master-side: APB slaves convert protocol to cmd/rsp - Internal: Arbitration + address decoding - Slave-side: APB masters convert cmd/rsp back to protocol

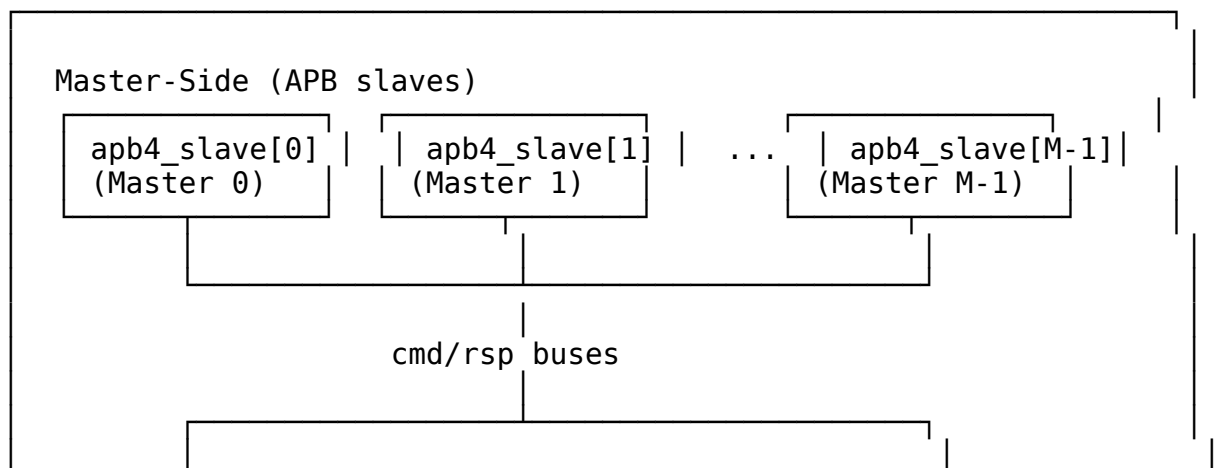
2.2 Design Trade-offs

Feature	Choice	Rationale
Arbitration	Round-robin per slave	Fair, simple, predictable
Address Map	64KB per slave	Sufficient for most peripherals
Grant Persistence	Hold through response	Zero-bubble throughput
Address Decode	Parallel decode	Low latency, simple logic

3. Architecture Overview

3.1 Top-Level Block Diagram

APB Crossbar (M masters × N slaves)



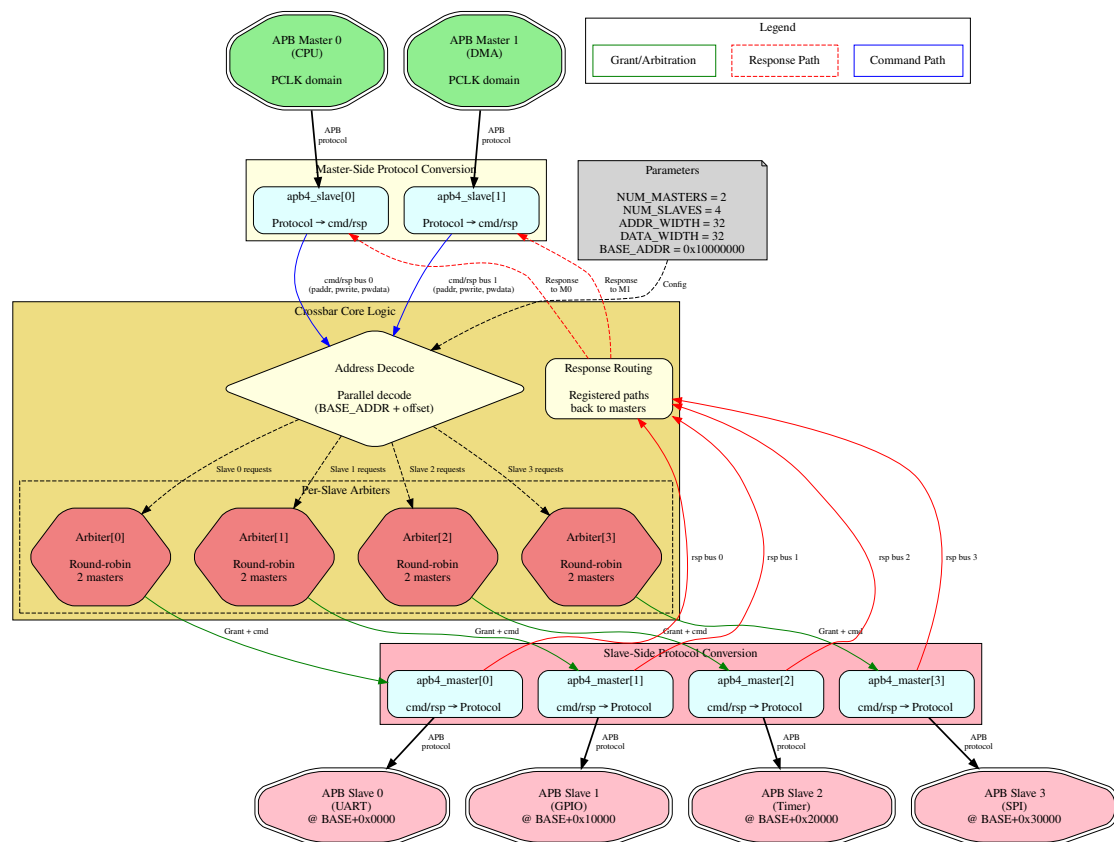
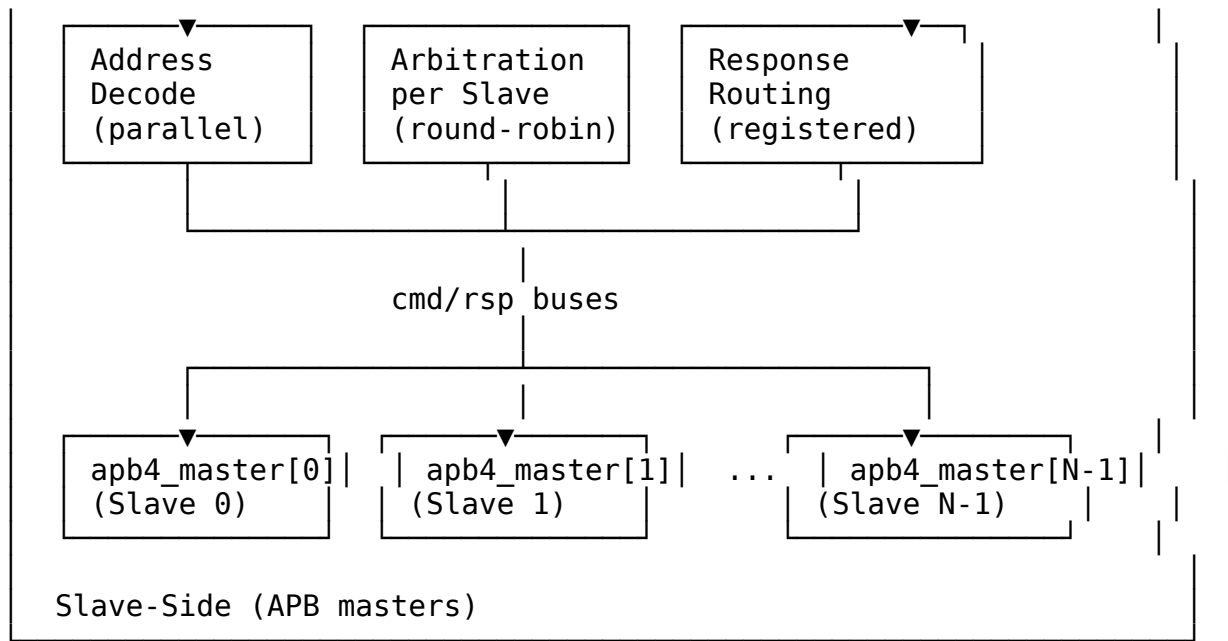


Figure:

APB Crossbar top-level architecture showing 2 masters connected to 4 slaves. [Source: docs/apbx_xbar_mas/assets/graphviz/apbx_xbar_architecture.gv](https://docs.apbx_xbar_mas/assets/graphviz/apbx_xbar_architecture.gv) | [SVG](#)

3.2 Address Mapping

BASE_ADDR + 0x0000_0000 → 0x0000_FFFF : Slave 0 (64KB)
BASE_ADDR + 0x0001_0000 → 0x0001_FFFF : Slave 1 (64KB)
BASE_ADDR + 0x0002_0000 → 0x0002_FFFF : Slave 2 (64KB)
BASE_ADDR + 0x0003_0000 → 0x0003_FFFF : Slave 3 (64KB)
...
BASE_ADDR + 0x000F_0000 → 0x000F_FFFF : Slave 15 (64KB)

Default BASE_ADDR: 0x1000_0000

Address Decode Example:

The crossbar extracts the slave index from the upper bits of the address offset:

`slave_index = (address - BASE_ADDR) >> 16 // Divide by 64KB (0x10000)`

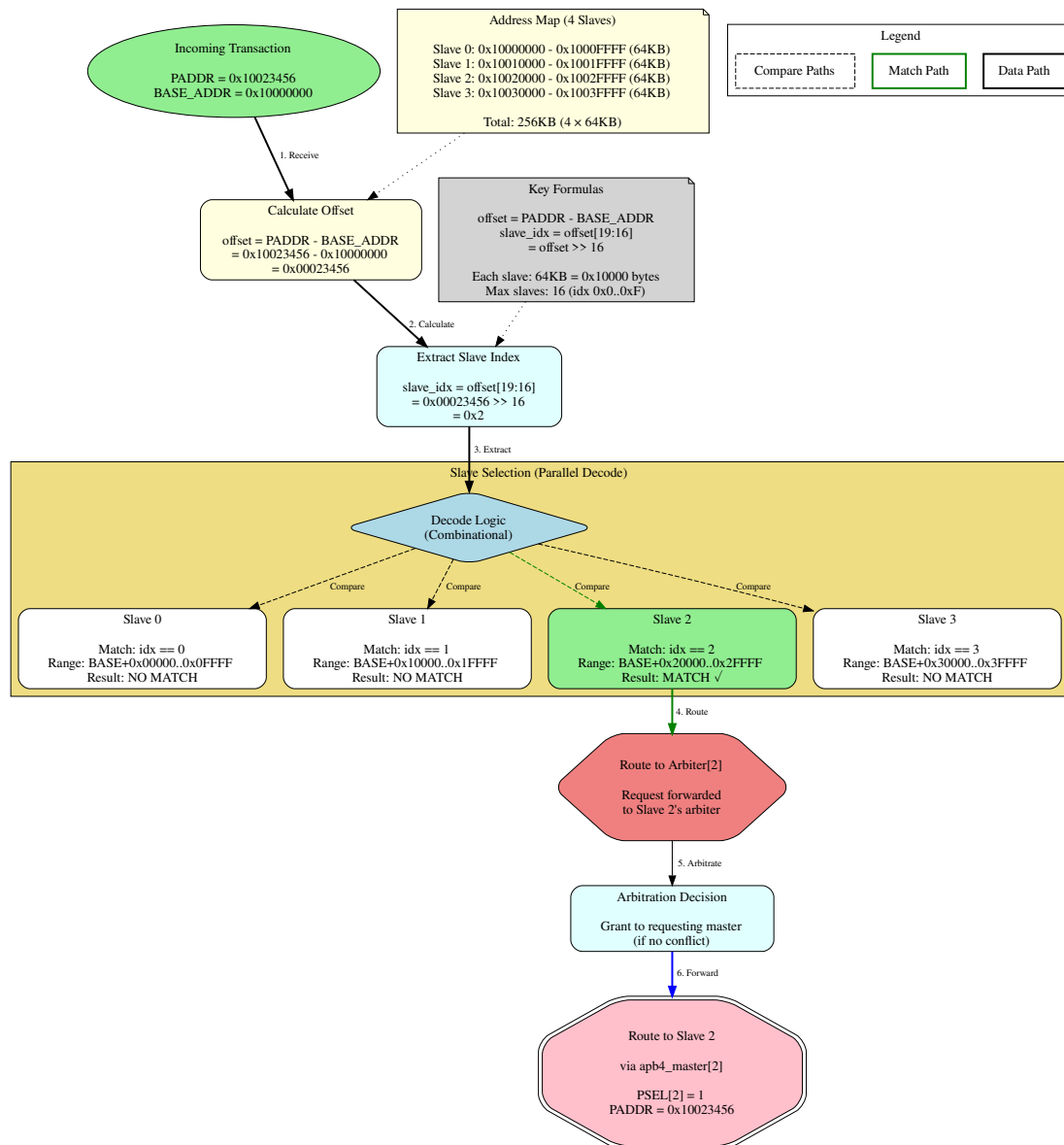


Figure:

Address decode flow showing how address 0x10023456 routes to Slave 2. [Source: docs/apbx_xbar_mas/assets/graphviz/address_decode_flow.gv](https://docs.apbx_xbar_mas/assets/graphviz/address_decode_flow.gv) | [SVG](#)

3.3 Arbitration Strategy

Per-Slave Round-Robin: - Each slave has independent arbiter - Master priority rotates after each grant - Grant held from command acceptance through response completion - No master can starve another master

Example:

Slave 0 accessed by M0, M1, M0 → Next grant goes to M1
 Slave 1 accessed by M1, M1, M0 → Next grant goes to M0

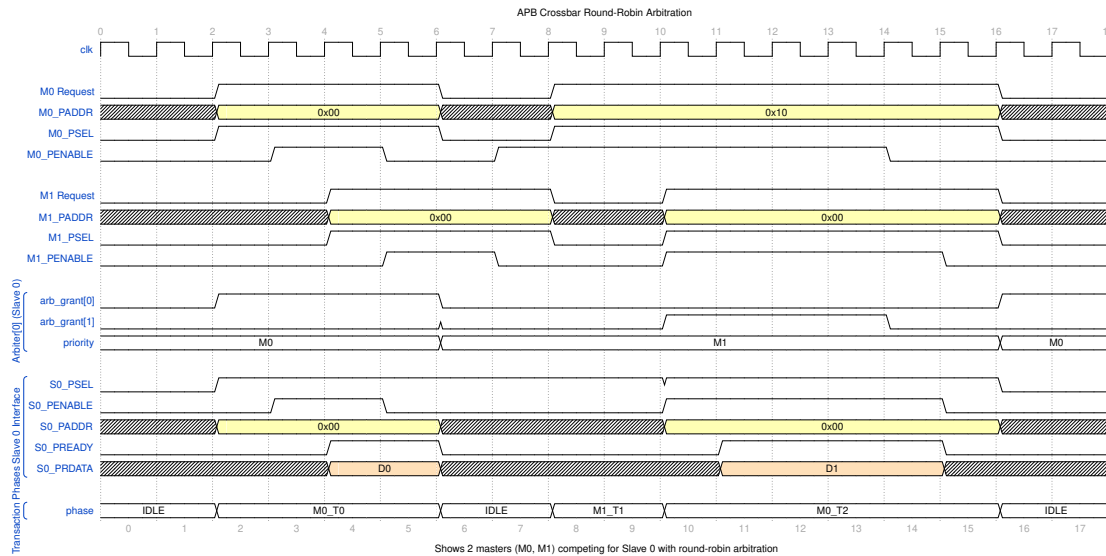


Figure:

Round-robin arbitration timing showing 2 masters competing for Slave 0. Master priority rotates after each grant to ensure fair access. [Source: docs/apbx_xbar_mas/assets/wavedrom/arbitration_round_robin.json](https://docs.apbx_xbar_mas/assets/wavedrom/arbitration_round_robin.json)

4. Available Variants

4.1 Pre-Generated Modules

Module	Masters	Slaves	Use Case	File Size
apbx_xbar_1to1	1	1	Protocol conversion, testing	~200 LOC
apbx_xbar_2to1	2	1	Multi-master arbitration	~400 LOC
apbx_xbar_1to4	1	4	Address decode, simple SoC	~500 LOC
apbx_xbar_2to4	2	4	Full crossbar, typical SoC	~1000 LOC
apbx_xbar_1thin	1	1	Minimal passthroug	~150 LOC

Module	Masters	Slaves	Use Case	File Size
h				

4.2 Wrapper Modules

Pre-configured wrappers for common topologies:

Wrapper	Configuration	Purpose
apbx_xbar_1to1_wrap	1×1	Simple connection
apbx_xbar_2to1_wrap	2×1	Dual-master arbitration
apbx_xbar_1to4_wrap	1×4	Single-master decode
apbx_xbar_2to4_wrap	2×4	Full SoC crossbar
apbx_xbar_wrap_m10_s10	10×10	Large crossbar
apbx_xbar_thin_wrap_m10_s10	10×10	Minimal version

5. Functional Requirements

FR-1: Arbitrary MxN Configuration

Priority: P0 (Critical) **Status:** ✓ Implemented and verified

Description: Generate crossbar for any M masters and N slaves (up to 16x16)

Verification: Generator creates valid RTL for all tested configurations

FR-2: Round-Robin Arbitration

Priority: P0 (Critical) **Status:** ✓ Implemented and verified

Description: Fair per-slave arbitration with rotating master priority

Verification: Arbitration stress tests (130+ transactions for 2to1)

FR-3: Address-Based Routing

Priority: P0 (Critical) **Status:** ✓ Implemented and verified

Description: Automatic slave selection based on address ranges

Verification: Address decode validation (200+ transactions for 1to4)

FR-4: Zero-Bubble Throughput

Priority: P1 (High) **Status:** ✓ Implemented and verified

Description: Back-to-back transactions supported without idle cycles

Verification: Performance tests show consecutive transactions

FR-5: Configurable Address Map

Priority: P1 (High) **Status:** ✓ Implemented and verified

Description: BASE_ADDR parameter sets base of address map

Verification: Tests with multiple BASE_ADDR values

6. Interface Specifications

6.1 Master-Side Interface (APB Slave)

Per-master APB slave interface:

input logic	m<i>_apb_PSEL
input logic	m<i>_apb_PENABLE
input logic [ADDR_WIDTH-1:0]	m<i>_apb_PADDR
input logic	m<i>_apb_PWRITE
input logic [DATA_WIDTH-1:0]	m<i>_apb_PWDATA
input logic [STRB_WIDTH-1:0]	m<i>_apb_PSTRB
input logic [2:0]	m<i>_apb_PPROT
output logic [DATA_WIDTH-1:0]	m<i>_apb_PRDATA
output logic	m<i>_apb_PSLVERR
output logic	m<i>_apb_PREADY

6.2 Slave-Side Interface (APB Master)

Per-slave APB master interface:

output logic	s<j>_apb_PSEL
output logic	s<j>_apb_PENABLE
output logic [ADDR_WIDTH-1:0]	s<j>_apb_PADDR
output logic	s<j>_apb_PWRITE
output logic [DATA_WIDTH-1:0]	s<j>_apb_PWDATA
output logic [STRB_WIDTH-1:0]	s<j>_apb_PSTRB
output logic [2:0]	s<j>_apb_PPROT
input logic [DATA_WIDTH-1:0]	s<j>_apb_PRDATA

input logic
input logic

s<j>_apb_PSLVERR
s<j>_apb_PREADY

7. Parameter Configuration

Parameter	Type	Default	Range	Description
ADDR_WIDTH	int	32	1-64	Address bus width
DATA_WIDTH	int	32	8,16,32,64	Data bus width
STRB_WIDTH	int	DATA_WIDTH H/8	-	Strobe width (auto- calc)
BASE_ADDR	logic[31: 0]	0x10000000	Any	Base address for slave map

8. Generator Usage

8.1 Pre-Generated Variants

Use existing modules directly:

```
# Available in projects/components/apbx-xbar/rtl/  
apbx_xbar_1to1.sv  
apbx_xbar_2to1.sv  
apbx_xbar_1to4.sv  
apbx_xbar_2to4.sv  
apbx_xbar_thin.sv
```

8.2 Custom Generation

Generate custom MxN crossbar:

```
cd projects/components/apbx-xbar/bin/  
python generate_xbars.py --masters 3 --slaves 6  
python generate_xbars.py --masters 4 --slaves 8 --base-addr 0x80000000
```

8.3 Generator Options

```
python generate_xbars.py --help
```

Options:

```
--masters M      Number of masters (1-16)  
--slaves N       Number of slaves (1-16)  
--base-addr ADDR Base address (default: 0x10000000)
```


--output FILE	Output file path
--thin	Generate thin variant (minimal logic)

9. Performance Characteristics

9.1 Latency

Path	Latency	Notes
Command path	1 cycle	APB slave → decode → APB master
Response path	1 cycle	APB master → routing → APB slave
Total	2 cycles min	APB protocol overhead

9.2 Throughput

- **Back-to-back transactions:** Supported
- **Zero-bubble overhead:** Yes (with grant persistence)
- **Maximum rate:** 1 transaction per 2 APB cycles per master

9.3 Resource Utilization (Estimated)

Configuration	LUTs	FFs	Notes
1to1	~50	~20	Passthrough
2to1	~150	~80	Arbitration
1to4	~200	~100	Address decode
2to4	~400	~200	Full crossbar
10to10	~5K	~2K	Large crossbar

10. Verification Status

10.1 Test Coverage

Test	Transactions	Status	Coverage
test_apbx_xbar_r_1to1	100+	✓ Pass	Basic connectivity
test_apbx_xbar_r_2to1	130+	✓ Pass	Arbitration stress
test_apbx_xbar_r_1to4	200+	✓ Pass	Address decode
test_apbx_xbar_r_2to4	350+	✓ Pass	Full crossbar stress

Overall: 100% passing, >750 total transactions tested

10.2 Test Methodology

Test Structure: - CocoTB framework - Random transaction generation - Variable delay profiles - Address range validation - Arbitration fairness checks

Verification Points: - Correct address routing - Round-robin arbitration - Response integrity - Back-to-back transactions - Error propagation

11. Integration Guide

11.1 Simple Integration (1to4)

```
apbx_xbar_1to4 #(
    .ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .DATA_WIDTH(32),
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h1000_0000)
) u_xbar (
    .pclk(apb_clk),
    .presetn(apb_rst_n),

    // Master interface
    .m0_apb_PSEL(cpu_psel),
    .m0_apb_PENABLE(cpu_penable),
    .m0_apb_PADDR(cpu_paddr),
    .m0_apb_PWRITE(cpu_pwrite),
    .m0_apb_PWDATA(cpu_pwdata),
    .m0_apb_PSTRB(cpu_pstrb),
```

```

.m0_apb_PPROT(cpu_pprot),
.m0_apb_PRDATA(cpu_prdata),
.m0_apb_PSLVERR(cpu_pslverr),
.m0_apb_PREADY(cpu_pready),

// Slave 0: UART (0x1000_0000 - 0x1000_FFFF)
.s0_apb_PSEL(uart_psel),
.s0_apb_PENABLE(uart_penable),
// ... (similar connections)

// Slave 1: GPIO (0x1001_0000 - 0x1001_FFFF)
.s1_apb_PSEL(gpio_psel),
// ... (similar connections)

// Slave 2: Timer (0x1002_0000 - 0x1002_FFFF)
// Slave 3: SPI (0x1003_0000 - 0x1003_FFFF)
);

```

11.2 Multi-Master Integration (2to4)

```

apbx_xbar_2to4 #(
    .ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .DATA_WIDTH(32),
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h1000_0000)
) u_xbar (
    .pclk(apb_clk),
    .presetn(apb_rst_n),

    // Master 0: CPU
    .m0_apb_PSEL(cpu_psel),
    // ... (full interface)

    // Master 1: DMA
    .m1_apb_PSEL(dma_psel),
    // ... (full interface)

    // Slaves 0-3: Peripherals
    // ... (slave connections)
);

```

12. Design Constraints

12.1 Limitations

Constraint	Value	Rationale
Max masters	16	Generator limit (configurable)
Max slaves	16	Generator limit (configurable)
Slave region size	64KB	Fixed per slave
No slave disable	N/A	All slaves always active
No timeout	N/A	Assumes slaves always respond

12.2 Assumptions

1. **Slave responses:** All slaves respond eventually (no timeout handling)
 2. **Address ranges:** Slaves occupy 64KB regions starting at BASE_ADDR
 3. **APB compliance:** All masters and slaves follow APB protocol
 4. **Single clock domain:** All signals synchronous to pclk
-

13. Future Enhancements

13.1 Potential Features

- **Configurable slave region sizes:** Not just 64KB
- **Slave enable/disable:** Dynamic slave activation
- **Timeout detection:** Watchdog for hung slaves
- **Transaction ordering:** Optional in-order completion
- **Priority arbitration:** Weighted instead of round-robin

13.2 Generator Improvements

- **HDL output formats:** Support Verilog, VHDL, Chisel
- **Automated testing:** Generate tests alongside RTL
- **Documentation generation:** Auto-generate integration guides
- **Synthesis scripts:** Generate vendor-specific scripts

14. References

14.1 Internal Documentation

- `README.md` - Quick start guide
- `CLAUDE.md` - AI assistant guidelines
- `bin/generate_xbars.py` - Generator script
- `dv/tests/` - Test implementations

14.2 External Standards

- **AMBA APB Protocol v2.0** - ARM IHI 0024C
- **APB4 Extensions** - AMBA 5 specification

14.3 Related Components

- `rtl/amba/apb4/apb4_slave.sv` - Master-side building block
 - `rtl/amba/apb4/apb4_master.sv` - Slave-side building block
 - `projects/components/apbx-xbar/bin/apbx_xbar_generator.py` - Main generator
-

Document Version: 1.0 **Last Review:** 2025-10-19 **Next Review:** 2026-01-01 **Maintained By:** RTL Design Sherpa Project

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Claude Code Guide: APB Crossbar Component

Version: 1.0 **Last Updated:** 2025-10-19 **Purpose:** AI-specific guidance for working with APB Crossbar component

Quick Context

What: APB Crossbar Generator - Parametric APB interconnect for connecting M masters to N slaves **Status:** ✓ Production Ready (all tests passing) **Your Role:** Help users generate, integrate, and customize APB crossbars

 **Complete Specification:** projects/components/apbx-xbar/PRD.md ← **Always reference this for technical details**

Critical Rules for This Component

Rule #0: This is a GENERATOR, Not Just Modules

IMPORTANT: APB Crossbar is both: 1. **Pre-generated modules** (1to1, 2to1, 1to4, 2to4, thin) in rtl/ 2. **Python generator** (bin/generate_xbars.py) for custom configurations

When users ask for crossbar: - ✓ **Check if pre-generated variant exists first** - ✓ **Only suggest generation if custom size needed**

Decision Tree:

User needs crossbar?

- └ 1x1, 2x1, 1x4, 2x4? → Use pre-generated module
- └ Thin/minimal? → Use apbx_xbar_thin
- └ Custom MxN? → Run generator script

Rule #1: Address Map is Fixed Per-Slave

Each slave occupies 64KB region:

Slave 0: BASE_ADDR + 0x0000_0000 → 0x0000_FFFF
Slave 1: BASE_ADDR + 0x0001_0000 → 0x0001_FFFF
Slave 2: BASE_ADDR + 0x0002_0000 → 0x0002_FFFF
...

Users CANNOT change per-slave size (current limitation)

If user asks for different sizes:

✗ **WRONG:** "Let me modify the generator to support custom sizes per slave"

✓ **CORRECT:** "Current design uses fixed 64KB per slave. You can:

1. Use BASE_ADDR parameter to shift entire map
2. For custom sizes, modify generator's addr_offset calculation
3. Or use multiple crossbars with different BASE_ADDR values"

Rule #2: Know the Pre-Generated Variants

Available in `rtl/` directory:

Module	M×N	Use Case	When to Recommend
apbx_xbar_1to1	1×1	Passthrough	Protocol conversion, testing
apbx_xbar_2to1	2×1	Arbitration	Multi-master to single peripheral
apbx_xbar_1to4	1×4	Decode	Single CPU to multiple peripherals
apbx_xbar_2to4	2×4	Full crossbar	CPU + DMA to peripherals
apbx_xbar_thin	1×1	Minimal	Low-overhead passthrough

Always suggest pre-generated first!

Rule #3: Generator Syntax

Generate custom crossbar:

```
cd projects/components/apbx-xbar/bin/
python generate_xbars.py --masters 3 --slaves 6
```

Options:

<code>--masters M</code>	Number of masters (1-16)
<code>--slaves N</code>	Number of slaves (1-16)
<code>--base-addr ADDR</code>	Base address (default: 0x10000000)
<code>--output FILE</code>	Output file path
<code>--thin</code>	Generate thin variant (minimal logic)

Example:

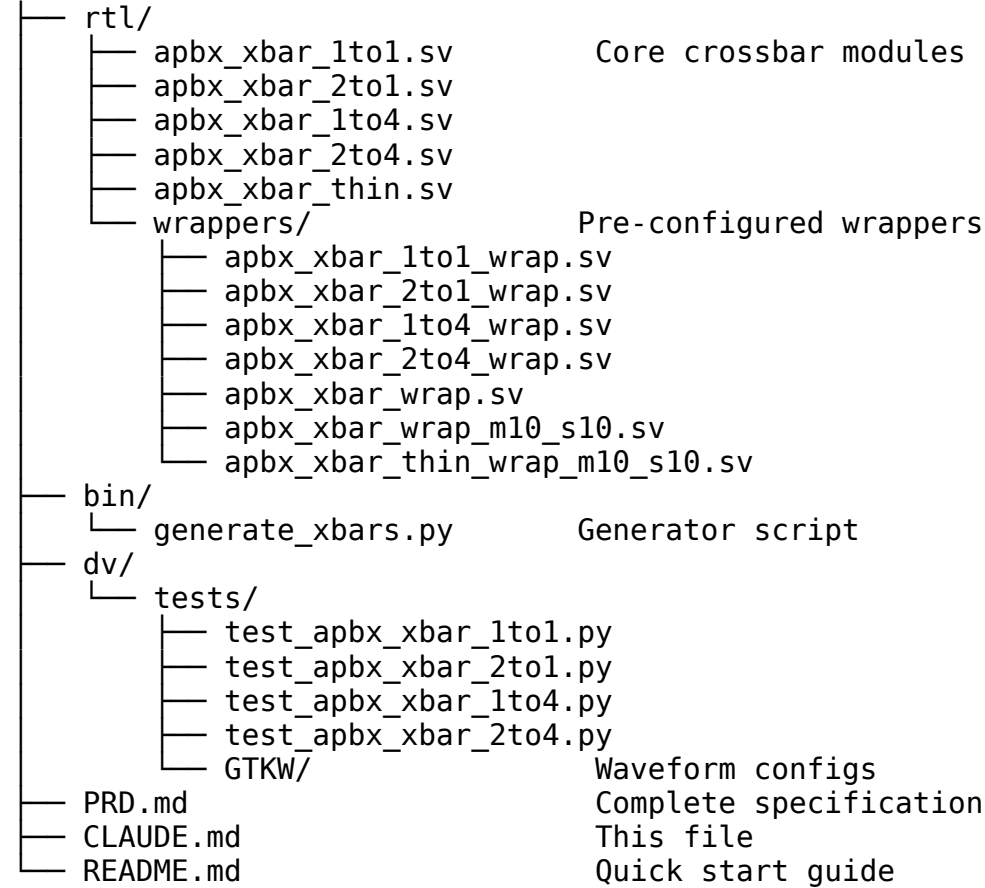
```
# Generate 3x8 crossbar with custom base
python generate_xbars.py --masters 3 --slaves 8 --base-addr 0x80000000

# Generate thin 5x5 variant
python generate_xbars.py --masters 5 --slaves 5 --thin
```

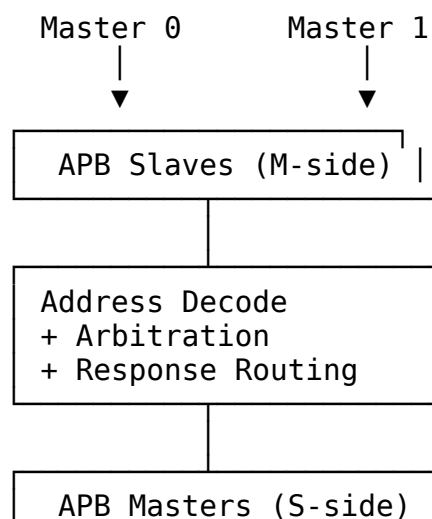
Architecture Quick Reference

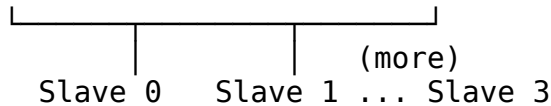
Module Organization

projects/components/apbx-xbar/



Block Diagram (2x4 Example)





Common User Questions and Responses

Q: “How do I connect a CPU to 4 peripherals?”

A: Use the pre-generated 1to4 crossbar:

```

apbx_xbar_1to4 #(
    .ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .DATA_WIDTH(32),
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h1000_0000) // Start of peripheral space
) u_peripheral_xbar (
    .pclk(apb_clk),
    .presetn(apb_rst_n),

    // CPU connection (master 0)
    .m0_apb_PSEL(cpu_psel),
    .m0_apb_PENABLE(cpu_penable),
    .m0_apb_PADDR(cpu_paddr),
    .m0_apb_PWRITE(cpu_pwrite),
    .m0_apb_PWDATA(cpu_pwdata),
    .m0_apb_PSTRB(cpu_pstrb),
    .m0_apb_PPROT(cpu_pprot),
    .m0_apb_PRDATA(cpu_prdata),
    .m0_apb_PSLVERR(cpu_pslverr),
    .m0_apb_PREADY(cpu_pready),

    // Peripheral 0: UART @ 0x1000_0000
    .s0_apb_PSEL(uart_psel),
    .s0_apb_PENABLE(uart_penable),
    // ... (full interface)

    // Peripheral 1: GPIO @ 0x1001_0000
    // Peripheral 2: Timer @ 0x1002_0000
    // Peripheral 3: SPI @ 0x1003_0000
);

```

Address map: - UART: 0x1000_0000 - 0x1000_FFFF - GPIO: 0x1001_0000 - 0x1001_FFFF - Timer: 0x1002_0000 - 0x1002_FFFF - SPI: 0x1003_0000 - 0x1003_FFFF

See: PRD.md Section 11.1

Q: “I need CPU and DMA to access peripherals. Which crossbar?”

A: Use the 2to4 crossbar:

```
apbx_xbar_2to4 #(
    .ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .DATA_WIDTH(32),
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h1000_0000)
) u_soc_xbar (
    .pclk(apb_clk),
    .presetn(apb_rst_n),

    // Master 0: CPU
    .m0_apb_PSEL(cpu_psel),
    // ... (full interface)

    // Master 1: DMA
    .m1_apb_PSEL(dma_psel),
    // ... (full interface)

    // Slaves 0-3: Peripherals
    // ... (slave connections)
);
```

Key feature: Round-robin arbitration per slave ensures fair access between CPU and DMA.

 **See:** PRD.md Section 11.2

Q: “What if I need 3 masters and 8 slaves?”

A: Generate custom crossbar:

```
cd projects/components/apbx-xbar/bin/
python generate_xbars.py --masters 3 --slaves 8 # writes
apbx_xbar_3to8.sv next to the script
```

```
# Check generated file, then move it into rtl/
ls -lh apbx_xbar_3to8.sv
mv apbx_xbar_3to8.sv ../rtl/
```

Then instantiate like any other crossbar:

```
apbx_xbar_3to8 #(
    .ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .DATA_WIDTH(32),
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h1000_0000)
) u_custom_xbar (
    // ... connections for 3 masters and 8 slaves
);
```

 **See:** PRD.md Section 8

Q: “How does arbitration work?”

A: Per-slave round-robin:

Each slave has its own arbiter that rotates master priority:

Example with 2 masters accessing Slave 0:

Transaction 1: M0 requests → M0 granted

Transaction 2: M0 and M1 request → M1 granted (rotated)

Transaction 3: M1 requests → M1 granted

Transaction 4: M0 and M1 request → M0 granted (rotated)

Key points: - **Independent per slave:** Each slave arbitrates independently - **Fair:** No master can starve another - **Grant persistence:** Once granted, master holds slave until response completes - **Zero-bubble:** Back-to-back transactions supported

 **See:** PRD.md Section 3.3

Q: “Can I change the address map?”

A: BASE_ADDR parameter shifts entire map, but per-slave size is fixed:

```
// Default: 0x1000_0000
apbx_xbar_lto4 #(.BASE_ADDR(32'h1000_0000)) u_xbar1 (...);
// Slaves at: 0x1000_0000, 0x1001_0000, 0x1002_0000, 0x1003_0000

// Shifted: 0x8000_0000
apbx_xbar_lto4 #(.BASE_ADDR(32'h8000_0000)) u_xbar2 (...);
// Slaves at: 0x8000_0000, 0x8001_0000, 0x8002_0000, 0x8003_0000
```

Limitation: Each slave always occupies 64KB (0x10000 bytes)

Workaround for different sizes: 1. Use multiple crossbars with different BASE_ADDR 2. Modify generator’s addr_offset calculation 3. Use address masking in slaves

 **See:** PRD.md Section 3.2

Q: “How do I run tests?”

A: Use pytest:

```
cd projects/components/apbx-xbar/dv/tests/
```

```
# Run specific test
pytest test_apbx_xbar_lto4.py -v
```

```
# Run all tests
```

```
pytest test_apbx_xbar_*.py -v
```

Run with waveforms

```
pytest test_apbx_xbar_2to4.py --vcd=waves.vcd
gtkwave waves.vcd
```

Test coverage: - **test_apbx_xbar_1to1:** 100+ transactions (passthrough) - **test_apbx_xbar_2to1:** 130+ transactions (arbitration) - **test_apbx_xbar_1to4:** 200+ transactions (address decode) - **test_apbx_xbar_2to4:** 350+ transactions (full stress)

All tests passing ✓

 **See:** PRD.md Section 10

Q: “What’s the thin variant for?”

A: Minimal overhead passthrough:

```
apbx_xbar_thin #(
    .ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .DATA_WIDTH(32)
) u_thin_xbar (
    // ... 1x1 connection
);
```

Use cases: - Protocol conversion - Timing boundary - Clock domain crossing preparation - Testing/debugging

Difference from apbx_xbar_1to1: - Fewer internal registers - Lower latency - Smaller area (~30% reduction) - No arbitration overhead

 **See:** README.md and PRD.md Section 4

Integration Patterns

Pattern 1: Simple Peripheral Interconnect

```
// CPU to 4 peripherals
apbx_xbar_1to4 #(
    .ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .DATA_WIDTH(32),
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h1000_0000)
) u_periph_xbar (
    .pclk(sys_clk),
    .presetn(sys_rst_n),

    // CPU side
```

```

.m0_apb_PSEL(cpu_apb_psel),
.m0_apb_PENABLE(cpu_apb_penable),
.m0_apb_PADDR(cpu_apb_paddr),
.m0_apb_PWRITE(cpu_apb_pwrite),
.m0_apb_PWDATA(cpu_apb_pwdata),
.m0_apb_PSTRB(cpu_apb_pstrb),
.m0_apb_PPROT(cpu_apb_pprot),
.m0_apb_PRDATA(cpu_apb_prdata),
.m0_apb_PSLVERR(cpu_apb_pslverr),
.m0_apb_PREADY(cpu_apb_pready),

// Peripherals
.s0_apb_PSEL(uart_psel), /* ... full interface ... */
.s1_apb_PSEL(gpio_psel), /* ... */
.s2_apb_PSEL(timer_psel), /* ... */
.s3_apb_PSEL(spi_psel) /* ... */
);

```

Pattern 2: Multi-Master System

```

// CPU + DMA to peripherals
apbx_xbar_2to4 #(
    .ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .DATA_WIDTH(32),
    .BASE_ADDR(32'h4000_0000)
) u_soc_xbar (
    .pclk(apb_clk),
    .presetn(apb_rst_n),

    // Master 0: CPU
    .m0_apb_PSEL(cpu_psel),
    /* ... full CPU interface ... */

    // Master 1: DMA Controller
    .m1_apb_PSEL(dma_psel),
    /* ... full DMA interface ... */

    // Slave 0-3: Memory-mapped peripherals
    .s0_apb_PSEL(mem_ctrl_psel), /* ... */
    .s1_apb_PSEL(uart_psel), /* ... */
    .s2_apb_PSEL(i2c_psel), /* ... */
    .s3_apb_PSEL(adc_psel) /* ... */
);

```

Pattern 3: Hierarchical Interconnect

```

// Top-level crossbar
apbx_xbar_1to4 u_top_xbar (
    .m0_apb_* (cpu_apb_*),

```

```

        .s0_apb_* (periph_bus0_*), // To sub-crossbar 0
        .s1_apb_* (periph_bus1_*), // To sub-crossbar 1
        .s2_apb_* (mem_ctrl_*),    // Direct to memory controller
        .s3_apb_* (dma_ctrl_*)     // Direct to DMA
    );

// Sub-crossbar 0 for low-speed peripherals
apbx_xbar_lto4 u_periph_xbar0 (
    .m0_apb_* (periph_bus0_*),
    .s0_apb_* (uart0_*),
    .s1_apb_* (gpio0_*),
    .s2_apb_* (i2c0_*),
    .s3_apb_* (spi0_*)
);

// Sub-crossbar 1 for high-speed peripherals
apbx_xbar_lto4 u_periph_xbar1 (
    .m0_apb_* (periph_bus1_*),
    .s0_apb_* (uart1_*),
    .s1_apb_* (timer_*),
    .s2_apb_* (pwm_*),
    .s3_apb_* (adc_*)
);

```

Anti-Patterns to Catch

✗ Anti-Pattern 1: Generating When Pre-Generated Exists

✗ WRONG:

User: "I need a 2x4 crossbar"

You: "Let me generate that for you..."

```
python generate_xbars.py --masters 2 --slaves 4
```

✓ CORRECTED:

"Use the pre-generated apbx_xbar_2to4.sv in the rtl/ directory.

No generation needed!"

✗ Anti-Pattern 2: Assuming Custom Per-Slave Sizes

✗ WRONG:

User: "Can I make slave 0 256KB and slave 1 4KB?"

You: "Sure, let me modify the parameters..."

✓ CORRECTED:

"Current design uses fixed 64KB per slave. For custom sizes:

1. Modify generator's addr_offset calculation

2. Or use multiple crossbars with different BASE_ADDR
3. Or implement address masking in slaves"

✗ Anti-Pattern 3: Not Mentioning Address Map

✗ WRONG:

User: "How do I integrate the crossbar?"

You: *Shows port connections only*

✓ CORRECTED:

"Here's the integration with address map:

```
apbx_xbar_lto4 #(.BASE_ADDR(32'h1000_0000)) u_xbar (...);
```

Address map:

- Slave 0: 0x1000_0000 - 0x1000_FFFF
- Slave 1: 0x1001_0000 - 0x1001_FFFF
- Slave 2: 0x1002_0000 - 0x1002_FFFF
- Slave 3: 0x1003_0000 - 0x1003_FFFF"

✗ Anti-Pattern 4: Forgetting About Wrappers

✗ WRONG:

User: "I need a quick 10x10 crossbar"

You: "Run the generator with --masters 10 --slaves 10"

✓ CORRECTED:

"We have pre-configured wrappers in rtl/wrappers/:

- apbx_xbar_wrap_m10_s10.sv (full version)
- apbx_xbar_thin_wrap_m10_s10.sv (thin version)

Use those for faster integration!"

Debugging Workflow

Issue: Address Not Routing Correctly

Check in order: 1. ✓ BASE_ADDR parameter set correctly? 2. ✓ Address within slave's 64KB region? 3. ✓ PSEL signal asserted by master? 4. ✓ All APB signals properly connected?

Calculate expected slave:

```
slave_index = (address - BASE_ADDR) >> 16 // Divide by 64KB
```

Debug commands:

```
pytest dv/tests/test_apbx_xbar_lto4.py --vcd=debug.vcd -v  
gtkwave debug.vcd # Check address decode logic
```

Issue: Arbitration Not Fair

Symptoms: - One master dominates - Other masters starved

Check: 1. ✓ Arbiters instantiated per slave? 2. ✓ Round-robin logic correct? 3. ✓ Grant persistence working?

Verify with tests:

```
pytest dv/tests/test_apbx_xbar_2to1.py -v # Arbitration stress test
```

Issue: Back-to-Back Transactions Stalling

Check: 1. ✓ Grant persistence enabled? 2. ✓ Slaves responding with PREADY? 3. ✓ No unintended pipeline bubbles?

View waveforms:

```
pytest dv/tests/test_apbx_xbar_2to4.py --vcd=perf.vcd
gtkwave perf.vcd # Check for idle cycles
```

Quick Commands

```
# List available crossbars
ls projects/components/apbx-xbar/rtl/*.sv

# Generate custom crossbar
cd projects/components/apbx-xbar/bin/
python generate_xbars.py --masters 3 --slaves 6

# Run all tests
cd projects/components/apbx-xbar/dv/tests/
pytest test_apbx_xbar_*.py -v

# Run specific test with waveforms
pytest test_apbx_xbar_2to4.py --vcd=debug.vcd -v

# View waveforms
gtkwave debug.vcd

# Check documentation
cat projects/components/apbx-xbar/PRD.md
cat projects/components/apbx-xbar/README.md
```

Remember

1. 🔍 **Check pre-generated first** - Don't generate unnecessarily
 2. 📍 **Address map matters** - Always mention BASE_ADDR + 64KB regions
 3. ⚖️ **Fair arbitration** - Round-robin per slave
 4. 🔗 **Complete connections** - All APB signals must be wired
 5. ✓ **Tests available** - 100% passing, comprehensive coverage
 6. 📖 **Wrappers exist** - Check rtl/wrappers/ for common configs
 7. 🎯 **Generator limits** - Up to 16×16 (configurable)
-

Version: 1.0 **Last Updated:** 2025-10-19 **Maintained By:** RTL Design Sherpa Project

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APB Crossbar Modules

This directory contains the APB crossbar family: a parameterized core plus generated fixed-configuration variants. Every port independently speaks **APB4 or APB5**, so one fabric can carry a mix of both.

The x in apbx is the version wildcard — it is not a separate protocol.

Architecture

Generated variants follow a consistent design:

Master Side:	apb4_slave / apb5_slave convert APB → cmd/rsp interface
Internal:	Round-robin arbitration + address decoding
Slave Side:	apb4_master / apb5_master convert cmd/rsp → APB interface

apbx_xbar_thin is a different architecture — a combinational passthrough with weighted round-robin and no cmd/rsp conversion. See [the docs](#) for choosing between them.

Key Features

- **Independent arbitration per slave:** Each slave has its own round-robin arbiter

- **Grant persistence:** Grants held from command acceptance through response completion
- **Address decoding:** Automatic slave selection based on address ranges
- **Mixed APB4/APB5:** per-port version selection, sideband gated at both ends
- **Proven architecture:** Uses production-tested apb4/apb5 slave and master modules

Why mixing needs no converters

APB5 is APB4's transfer protocol plus extra sideband pins — the handshake and phases are identical. So sideband rides the same select/grant/demux muxes as PADDR, and the version selection only gates *contribution*: an APB4 master contributes '0, and an APB4 slave is never driven with nonzero sideband. Both gates are compile-time constants, so synthesis prunes any pairing that cannot occur, and an all-APB4 build is bit-identical to the pre-APB5 crossbar.

Available Modules

Module	Description	Masters	Slaves	Use Case
apbx_xbar_1to1.sv	Simple passthrough	1	1	Protocol conversion, testing
apbx_xbar_2to1.sv	Arbitration only	2	1	Multi-master to single slave
apbx_xbar_1to4.sv	Address decode only	1	4	Single master to multi-slave
apbx_xbar_2to4.sv	Full crossbar	2	4	Multi-master to multi-slave
apbx_xbar_2to2_mixed.sv	Mixed APB4/APB5	2	2	m0=APB4, m1=APB5, s0=APB5, s1=APB4
apbx_xbar_thin.sv	Parameterized core	M	S	Any topology; versions set by parameter

Generating Crossbars

Method 1: Convenience Script (Recommended)

Generate all standard variants:

```
cd projects/components/apbx-xbar/bin/  
python generate_xbars.py
```

Generate custom variant:

```
python generate_xbars.py --masters 3 --slaves 6  
python generate_xbars.py --masters 4 --slaves 8 --base-addr 0x80000000
```

Generate a mixed-version variant — versions are positional per port, and are baked in at generation time rather than being a runtime parameter:

```
# in generate_xbars.py  
mixed = [  
    ((2, 2), ['apb4', 'apb5'], ['apb5', 'apb4'], '_mixed'),  
]
```

rtl/*.sv is generator output. The generator emits the final form (SPDX banner, reset_defs.svh include, reset macros) straight into rtl/, so there is no post-processing step and nothing to hand-edit. Regeneration is idempotent:

```
python3 generate_xbars.py && git status --short ../rtl/ # expect no  
output
```

Method 2: Direct Generator

Use the main generator for more control:

```
cd projects/components/apbx-xbar/bin/  
python apbx_xbar_generator.py --masters 2 --slaves 4 --output  
../rtl/apbx_xbar_2to4.sv
```

Address Map

All crossbars use a uniform address mapping (configurable via BASE_ADDR parameter):

```
Slave 0: [BASE_ADDR + 0x0000_0000, BASE_ADDR + 0x0000_FFFF] (64KB)  
Slave 1: [BASE_ADDR + 0x0001_0000, BASE_ADDR + 0x0001_FFFF] (64KB)  
Slave 2: [BASE_ADDR + 0x0002_0000, BASE_ADDR + 0x0002_FFFF] (64KB)  
Slave 3: [BASE_ADDR + 0x0003_0000, BASE_ADDR + 0x0003_FFFF] (64KB)  
...
```

Default BASE_ADDR: 0x1000_0000

Parameters

All modules support these parameters:

Parameter	Default	Description
ADDR_WIDTH	32	Address bus width
DATA_WIDTH	32	Data bus width
STRB_WIDTH	DATA_WIDTH/8	Strobe width (auto-calculated)
BASE_ADDR	0x10000000	Base address for slave address map

Usage Example

```
apbx_xbar_2to4 #(
    .ADDR_WIDTH (32),
    .DATA_WIDTH (32),
    .BASE_ADDR  (32'h8000_0000)
) u_xbar (
    .pclk      (apb_clk),
    .presetn   (apb_rst_n),

    // Master 0 interface
    .m0_apb_PSEL    (m0_psel),
    .m0_apb_PENABLE (m0_penable),
    .m0_apb_PADDR   (m0_paddr),
    .m0_apb_PWRITE  (m0_pwrite),
    .m0_apb_PWDATA  (m0_pwdata),
    .m0_apb_PSTRB   (m0_pstrb),
    .m0_apb_PPROT   (m0_pprot),
    .m0_apb_PRDATA  (m0_prdata),
    .m0_apb_PSLVERR (m0_pslverr),
    .m0_apb_PREADY  (m0_pready),

    // Master 1 interface
    .m1_apb_PSEL    (m1_psel),
    // ... (similar connections)

    // Slave 0-3 interfaces
    .s0_apb_PSEL    (s0_psel),
    // ... (similar connections)
);
```

Testing

All generated crossbars have corresponding test files in `dv/tests/`:

- `test_apbx_xbar_1to1.py` - 100+ transactions, variable delay profiles
- `test_apbx_xbar_2to1.py` - 130+ transactions, arbitration stress tests
- `test_apbx_xbar_1to4.py` - 200+ transactions, address decode validation
- `test_apbx_xbar_2to4.py` - 350+ transactions, full crossbar stress
- `test_apbx_xbar_2to2_mixed.py` - all four version pairings on the generated mixed fabric: sideband value where both ends are APB5, no leak anywhere else, plus a structural check that APB4 ports carry no sideband pins
- `test_apbx_xbar_thin_mixed.py` - the same pairing matrix against `apbx_xbar_thin` with `MST_APB5/SLV_APB5` masks

The mixed tests drive their DUT directly; the four legacy tests drive a `rtl/wrappers/*_wrap.sv` scaffold. Those wrappers are hand-written testbench scaffolding, not generator output, so a variant gets one only when a test needs it.

Run tests:

```
pytest projects/components/apbx-xbar/dv/tests/test_apbx_xbar_2to4.py -v
pytest projects/components/apbx-xbar/dv/tests/ -v # All variants
```

Design Notes

Arbitration Strategy

- **Round-robin per slave:** Master priority rotates ($M0 \rightarrow M1 \rightarrow M0 \dots$)
- **Grant persistence:** Once granted, master owns slave until transaction completes
- **Fairness:** No master can starve another master

Address Decoding

- **Parallel decode:** All masters decode addresses simultaneously
- **Registered routing:** Slave selection registered at command acceptance
- **Response routing:** Based on registered slave selection

Timing

- **Zero bubble overhead:** Back-to-back transactions supported

- **Single-cycle arbitration:** New grants issued in same cycle as previous completion
- **Pipelined datapath:** Command and response phases overlap different transactions

Known Limitations

1. **Fixed address map:** 64KB regions per slave
 - Can be changed by modifying generator's `addr_offset` calculation
2. **No slave disable:** All slaves always active
 - Could add enable parameter if needed
3. **No timeout handling:** Assumes slaves always respond
 - Add watchdog if needed for unreliable slaves

Generating Custom Variants

For variants beyond 16x16, modify generator limits in `apbx_xbar_generator.py`:

```
if M < 1 or M > 16: # Change 16 to desired max
    raise ValueError(f"Number of masters must be 1-16, got {M}")
```

Files

- `generate_xbars.py` - Convenience script for generation
- `apbx_xbar_1to1.sv` - 1-to-1 passthrough
- `apbx_xbar_2to1.sv` - 2-to-1 with arbitration
- `apbx_xbar_1to4.sv` - 1-to-4 with address decode
- `apbx_xbar_2to4.sv` - 2-to-4 full crossbar
- `README.md` - This file

References

- APB Specification: ARM IHI 0024C (AMBA APB Protocol v2.0), and IHI 0024E for the APB5 sideband signals
- Documentation: [docs/markdown/rtl-amba/apbx/](#)
- Generator: `projects/components/apbx-xbar/bin/apbx_xbar_generator.py`
- Base modules: `rtl/amba/apb4/apb4_{slave,master}.sv`, `rtl/amba/apb5/apb5_{slave,master}.sv`
- Formal: `formal/apbx_xbar/` (all-APB4 configuration)

- Tests: `dv/tests/test_apbx_xbar_*.py`

Not implemented

- **APB5 parity** (PSELPARITY and friends) is not carried across the fabric. Boundary IP is instantiated with `ENABLE_PARITY=0` and the parity pins tied off. Adding it is a separate change with its own protection-domain argument.
 - **Formal proofs cover the all-APB4 configuration only.** The harnesses were updated for the new ports and still pass, but nothing yet proves the version gating itself.
-

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